MONOTONICITY OF ERDŐS SUMS

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ABSTRACT. For $k \geq 1$ let $f_k = \sum_{\Omega(n)=k} 1/(n \log n)$, where Ω counts prime factors with multiplicity, and let g_k be the same sum restricted to odd n. Lichtman showed that $f_k \to 1$, with a global minimum at $k = 6$, and Gorodetsky, Lichtman and Wong that $f_k = 1 - 2^{-k}\big(a_1 k^2 + O(k \log(k+1))\big)$. We prove that $f_k < f_{k+1}$ for every $k \geq 6$, and that $g_k > g_{k+1}$ for every $k \geq 1$. The two statements come from one analytic distinction. Writing $\sum_k P_k(s) z^k = \zeta(s)^z H(s, z)$, at $s = 1$ the point $z = 2$ lies on the first singular circle of H, and strictly inside the first singular circle of the product with the prime 2 removed. We show that this distinction decides the direction in general. If the complement of a set of primes $\mathcal{P}$ is thin and its least element is at least 3, the corresponding sums eventually decrease; if $2 \in \mathcal{P}$, the question reduces to a single asymptotic in which no primes appear. The inequalities used at the last step of the first theorem are certified by interval arithmetic, and the reductions are formalized in Lean 4 as an implication from those inputs.

1. INTRODUCTION

For $k \geq 1$ put

$$f_k = \sum_{\Omega(n)=k} \frac{1}{n \log n}.$$

Erdős [4] proved that the corresponding sum is bounded uniformly over primitive sets. In particular each f_k converges. Zhang [10] proved $f_k < f_1$ for $k > 1$, and Bayless, Kinlaw and Klyve [11] proved $f_2 > f_3$. Banks and Martin [1] conjectured that

$$f_1 > f_2 > f_3 > \cdots . \tag{1}$$

Lichtman [2] disproved (1), showing that $f_k \to 1$ and that the sequence attains a global minimum at $k = 6$. Gorodetsky, Lichtman and Wong [3] then established

$$f_k = 1 - 2^{-k}\big(a_1 k^2 + O(k \log(k+1))\big), \qquad a_1 = \frac{d \log 2}{4} > 0, \tag{2}$$

where

$$d = \frac{1}{4} \prod_{p \geq 3} \left(1 - \frac{2}{p}\right)^{-1} \left(1 - \frac{1}{p}\right)^{2}. \tag{3}$$

Neither of these yields monotonicity beyond the minimum. A global minimum at $k = 6$ leaves open whether $f_k < f_{k+1}$ holds at every index above it, and the implicit constant in (2) does not make explicit a range on which the increase can be read off. Our first theorem gives that monotonicity in full.

Theorem 1.1. *For every $k \geq 6$ we have $f_k < f_{k+1}$.*

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Let

$$g_k = \sum_{\substack{n \text{ odd} \\ \Omega(n)=k}} \frac{1}{n \log n}.$$

The second theorem shows that deleting the prime 2 reverses the direction of monotonicity at every index.

Theorem 1.2. *For every $k \geq 1$ we have $g_k > g_{k+1}$, and $g_k \to \frac{1}{2}$.*

The proof of Theorem 1.2 gives the more precise expansion

$$g_k = \frac{1}{2} + \beta 2^{-k} + R_k, \qquad |R_k| \leq 4900(k+3)^3 3^{-k} \quad (k \geq 59), \tag{4}$$

where $\gamma = 0.5772156649\ldots$ is Euler's constant and

$$\beta = d\left(\gamma + \log 2 - \sum_{p \geq 3} \frac{\log p}{(p-1)(p-2)}\right) > 0. \tag{5}$$

The 2^{-k} term comes from evaluating a regularized Euler product at $z = 2$. For odd integers the first pole is at $z = 3$, so this evaluation takes place strictly inside the disc of analyticity. For the unrestricted sums the first pole is at $z = 2$ itself. The boundary contribution then acquires the factor k^2 in (2).

This contrast is not an accident of the two cases. In Section 7 we make it a general statement. Let $\mathcal{P}$ be a set of primes with least element $q \geq 3$, and suppose its complement $\mathcal{Q}$ is thin, in the sense that $\sum_{p \in \mathcal{Q}} (\log p)/p < \infty$. Then Proposition 7.2 gives

$$f_k^{\mathcal{P}} = \prod_{p \in \mathcal{Q}} \Big(1 - \frac{1}{p}\Big) + c_{\mathcal{P}} 2^{-k} + o(2^{-k}), \qquad c_{\mathcal{P}} = H_{\mathcal{P}}(1,2)\big(\gamma + \tfrac{1}{2}\partial_s \log H_{\mathcal{P}}(1,2)\big),$$

and Corollary 7.3 gives $c_{\mathcal{P}} > 0$, so every such family eventually decreases. Thus Theorem 1.2 is the case $\mathcal{Q} = \{2\}$ of a phenomenon that depends only on the position of $z = 2$ relative to the first singular circle. Both hypotheses are used. Thinness does not follow from $q \geq 3$: for $\mathcal{P} = \{p \equiv 1 \bmod 4\}$ the leading product is 0, and the proposition says nothing.

The remaining case is $2 \in \mathcal{P}$, where the evaluation sits on the singular circle. In §7.1 we reduce it to a single asymptotic for an integral containing no primes at all. Granting that asymptotic, every such family eventually increases. This is weaker than Theorem 1.1, which gives $f_k < f_{k+1}$ at every index $k \geq 6$, and it is for the explicit range that the certified computations are needed. The asymptotic remains out of reach, and Conjecture 7.1 records what it would give.

The proof has two kinds of input. Identities, coefficient reductions and inequalities are proved in the text. Bounds produced by interval arithmetic are isolated as certified propositions, so that a phrase of the form "the computation gives" never stands in for an analytic step: the exact inequality the computation supplies is stated before it is used. What the interval arithmetic certifies is the computation itself. Transcribing an enclosure into a numeral printed here, and combining several such numerals, is ordinary writing, and we check it by script rather than by ball arithmetic.

2. Generating functions and the analytic boundary

For $s > 1$ define

$$P_k(s) = \sum_{\Omega(n)=k} n^{-s}, \qquad P_k^{\mathrm{odd}}(s) = \sum_{\substack{n \text{ odd} \\ \Omega(n)=k}} n^{-s}.$$

Lemma 2.1. *For every $k \geq 1$,*

$$f_k = \int_1^\infty P_k(s)\,\mathrm{d}s, \qquad g_k = \int_1^\infty P_k^{\mathrm{odd}}(s)\,\mathrm{d}s. \tag{6}$$

Proof. The first identity is [2, (3.1)]: one has $\int_1^\infty n^{-s}\,\mathrm{d}s = 1/(n\log n)$ for $n \geq 2$, and the summands are non-negative, so Tonelli's theorem permits the interchange. The same calculation with the sum restricted to odd n gives the second. □

The generating functions are, by [2, Prop. 3.1],

$$\sum_{k\geq 0} P_k(s)z^k = \prod_p (1-zp^{-s})^{-1}, \qquad \sum_{k\geq 0} P_k^{\mathrm{odd}}(s)z^k = \prod_{p\geq 3}(1-zp^{-s})^{-1}. \tag{7}$$

Write these products as $\zeta(s)^z H(s,z)$ and $\zeta(s)^z H_{\mathrm{o}}(s,z)$, where

$$H(s,z) = \prod_p (1-zp^{-s})^{-1}(1-p^{-s})^z, \tag{8}$$

$$H_{\mathrm{o}}(s,z) = (1-2^{-s})^z \prod_{p\geq 3}(1-zp^{-s})^{-1}(1-p^{-s})^z. \tag{9}$$

Proposition 2.2. *Let $\sigma = \operatorname{Re} s$. Then H is analytic in the two complex variables (s,z) on $\{\sigma > 1/2,\ |z| < 2^\sigma\}$, and H_{o} on $\{\sigma > 1/2,\ |z| < 3^\sigma\}$. In particular, for fixed real $s > 1/2$ the function $H(s,\cdot)$ is analytic in $|z| < 2^s$ and $H_{\mathrm{o}}(s,\cdot)$ in $|z| < 3^s$; each $\partial_s^r H_{\mathrm{o}}(s,\cdot)$ is again analytic in $|z| < 3^s$, and*

$$\frac{\mathrm{d}^r}{\mathrm{d}s^r}[z^j]H_{\mathrm{o}}(s,z) = [z^j]\partial_s^r H_{\mathrm{o}}(s,z); \tag{10}$$

the same holds for H in $|z| < 2^s$.

Proof. It is essential that s be taken complex here: uniform convergence of real-variable functions says nothing about the derivative of the limit, so the real-variable argument would give analyticity in z alone.

Let $x = p^{-s}$, so that $|x| = p^{-\sigma} < 2^{-1/2}$ on the domain. The factor $(1-x)^z$ needs a branch, and the principal one serves throughout, since $1-x$ lies in the disc of radius $2^{-1/2} < 1$ about 1. Fix a compact subset of the domain, so that $\sigma \geq s_0 > 1/2$ and $|z| \leq R < 2^{s_0}$ for (8), or $R < 3^{s_0}$ with $p \geq 3$ for (9); then $|zx| < 1$ for every p occurring. The logarithm of the pth regularized factor is

$$-\log(1-zx) + z\log(1-x) = \sum_{m\geq 1} \frac{z^m - z}{m} x^m = \sum_{m\geq 2} \frac{z^m - z}{m} x^m = O(p^{-2\sigma}), \tag{11}$$

the $m = 1$ terms cancelling. The estimate is uniform on the compact set and depends on s only through σ. Each $p^{-s} = \mathrm{e}^{-s\log p}$ is entire, so every regularized factor is analytic in (s,z) jointly wherever its denominator does not vanish, and on $\{|z| < 3^\sigma\}$ it does not, since $|z| < 3^\sigma \leq |p^s|$ for every $p \geq 3$. As $\sum_p p^{-2s_0} < \infty$, the product converges locally uniformly on the stated domain in $\mathbb{C}^2$, and a locally uniform limit of analytic functions of several complex variables is analytic. This is the first assertion, the nearest pole being at $z = p^s$ with $|p^s| = 2^\sigma$ for (8) and 3^σ for (9). Finally $[z^j]$ is a Cauchy integral over a circle that may be held fixed on a compact subset, so it commutes with $\mathrm{d}/\mathrm{d}s$, which is (10). □

At $s = 1$ the point $z = 2$ lies on the first singular circle for H and lies strictly inside the first singular circle for H_{o}. This is the analytic distinction used below.

We shall also need the local change of variables used in the odd case.

Lemma 2.3. *Let $u = \log\zeta(s)$ for $s > 1$, and let $s = s(u)$ be the inverse function. Put $\varepsilon(u) = s(u) - 1$ and $J(u) = -s'(u)$. As $u \to \infty$,*

$$\varepsilon(u) = \mathrm{e}^{-u} + \gamma\mathrm{e}^{-2u} + O(\mathrm{e}^{-3u}), \qquad J(u) = \mathrm{e}^{-u} + 2\gamma\mathrm{e}^{-2u} + O(\mathrm{e}^{-3u}). \tag{12}$$

Proof. The point of the argument is that the expansions below are convergent power series and not merely asymptotic, which is what allows the second of them to be differentiated term by term.

By the Laurent expansion of ζ at its simple pole [8, Ch. 1], the function $\varepsilon \mapsto \varepsilon\,\zeta(1+\varepsilon)$ is analytic near $\varepsilon = 0$ with expansion $1 + \gamma\varepsilon + O(\varepsilon^2)$. Hence

$$x = \frac{1}{\zeta(1+\varepsilon)} = \frac{\varepsilon}{\varepsilon\,\zeta(1+\varepsilon)}$$

is analytic near $\varepsilon = 0$, with $x(0) = 0$ and $x = \varepsilon - \gamma\varepsilon^2 + O(\varepsilon^3)$, so in particular $\mathrm{d}x/\,\mathrm{d}\varepsilon = 1 \neq 0$ at the origin. By the inverse function theorem for analytic functions, ε is therefore an analytic function of x near $x = 0$, given by a convergent power series

$$\varepsilon = \psi(x) = x + \gamma x^2 + O(x^3),$$

which is the first formula in (12) once $x = \mathrm{e}^{-u}$. Because ψ is analytic rather than merely asymptotic, it may be differentiated termwise: $\psi'(x) = 1 + 2\gamma x + O(x^2)$. With $x = \mathrm{e}^{-u}$ one has $\mathrm{d}x/\,\mathrm{d}u = -x$, so the chain rule gives

$$\varepsilon'(u) = \psi'(x)\frac{\mathrm{d}x}{\mathrm{d}u} = -x\big(1 + 2\gamma x + O(x^2)\big) = -x - 2\gamma x^2 + O(x^3),$$

and $J(u) = -\varepsilon'(u) = x + 2\gamma x^2 + O(x^3)$. □

3. The odd sums

Throughout this section write

$$h_j(s) = [z^j]H_{\mathrm{o}}(s,z), \qquad b_j = h_j'(1) + 2\gamma h_j(1).$$

Since $\zeta(s)^z = \sum_{m\geq 0}(\log\zeta(s))^m z^m/m!$, coefficient extraction in (7) gives the exact identity

$$P_k^{\mathrm{odd}}(s) = \sum_{j=0}^{k} h_j(s)\frac{(\log\zeta(s))^{k-j}}{(k-j)!}. \tag{13}$$

Using $u = \log\zeta(s)$ in Lemma 2.1, and noting that s decreases from ∞ to 1 as u increases from 0 to ∞, we obtain

$$g_k = \sum_{j=0}^{k}\int_0^\infty \frac{u^{k-j}}{(k-j)!}\,h_j(s(u))J(u)\,\mathrm{d}u. \tag{14}$$

3.1. The first two terms.

Proposition 3.1. *With h_j and b_j as above and E_j as in the proof below, put*

$$R_k = \sum_{j=0}^{k}\int_0^\infty \frac{u^{k-j}}{(k-j)!}E_j(u)\,\mathrm{d}u - \sum_{j>k} h_j(1) - 2^{-k-1}\sum_{j>k} b_j 2^j. \tag{15}$$

Then

$$g_k = H_{\mathrm{o}}(1,1) + 2^{-k-1}\big(\partial_s H_{\mathrm{o}}(1,2) + 2\gamma H_{\mathrm{o}}(1,2)\big) + R_k. \tag{16}$$

Proof. The idea is to write the integrand of (14) as its first two terms in e^{-u} plus an explicit error, and then to integrate each piece exactly. Two expansions are at work and they must be kept apart: the measure $J(u)\,\mathrm{d}u$, which Lemma 2.3 expands, and the coefficient $h_j(s(u))$, which Taylor's theorem expands about $s = 1$. Their product supplies the three error terms of (17).

Let $x = \mathrm{e}^{-u}$. By Lemma 2.3, $J(u) = x + 2\gamma x^2 + O(x^3)$ and $\varepsilon(u)J(u) = x^2 + O(x^3)$. Taylor's theorem at $s = 1$ gives

$$h_j(1+\varepsilon) = h_j(1) + \varepsilon h_j'(1) + \frac{\varepsilon^2}{2} h_j''(1+\theta_{j,u}\varepsilon)$$

for some $0 < \theta_{j,u} < 1$. Put

$$r_0(u) = J(u) - \mathrm{e}^{-u} - 2\gamma \mathrm{e}^{-2u}, \qquad r_1(u) = \varepsilon(u)J(u) - \mathrm{e}^{-2u}.$$

Multiplication by $J(u)$ now gives the exact identity

$$\begin{aligned} h_j(s(u))J(u) &= h_j(1)\mathrm{e}^{-u} + b_j \mathrm{e}^{-2u} + E_j(u), \\ E_j(u) &= h_j(1)r_0(u) + h_j'(1)r_1(u) + \frac{\varepsilon(u)^2 J(u)}{2} h_j''(1+\theta_{j,u}\varepsilon(u)). \end{aligned} \tag{17}$$

No error is suppressed in the notation E_j: its three summands are the Jacobian error, the first-order coordinate error and the Taylor remainder.

Insert (17) into (14). Since

$$\int_0^\infty \frac{u^m}{m!} \mathrm{e}^{-ru}\,\mathrm{d}u = r^{-m-1} \qquad (r > 0),$$

the first two terms become

$$\sum_{j=0}^{k} h_j(1) = H_{\mathrm{o}}(1,1) - \sum_{j>k} h_j(1), \tag{18}$$

$$\sum_{j=0}^{k} b_j 2^{-(k-j+1)} = 2^{-k-1}\big(\partial_s H_{\mathrm{o}}(1,2) + 2\gamma H_{\mathrm{o}}(1,2)\big) - 2^{-k-1}\sum_{j>k} b_j 2^j. \tag{19}$$

Substituting (18) and (19), and collecting the E_j integrals with the two tails, is exactly (15), and this gives (16). Note that (15) is an identity, so every later estimate is an estimate of those three explicit quantities. □

Lemma 3.2. *One has*

$$H_{\mathrm{o}}(1,1) = \frac{1}{2}, \qquad H_{\mathrm{o}}(1,2) = d, \tag{20}$$

and

$$\partial_s \log H_{\mathrm{o}}(1,2) = 2\log 2 - 2\sum_{p\geq 3} \frac{\log p}{(p-1)(p-2)}. \tag{21}$$

Proof. The first two values are immediate from (9): at $s = z = 1$ every factor in the product over $p \geq 3$ cancels, leaving $H_{\mathrm{o}}(1,1) = 1 - 2^{-1} = \frac{1}{2}$, and at $(s,z) = (1,2)$ the product is (3), so $H_{\mathrm{o}}(1,2) = d$.

For the derivative, take logarithms:

$$\log H_{\mathrm{o}}(s,2) = 2\log(1-2^{-s}) + \sum_{p\geq 3} \left[-\log(1-2p^{-s}) + 2\log(1-p^{-s})\right].$$

The differentiated pth summand is $O((\log p)p^{-2s})$ locally uniformly near $s = 1$, so termwise differentiation is permitted. At $s = 1$ the first term contributes $2\log 2$, while the pth summand contributes

$$-\frac{2\log p}{p-2} + \frac{2\log p}{p-1} = -\frac{2\log p}{(p-1)(p-2)}.$$

Summing over $p \geq 3$ proves (21). □

Combining Proposition 3.1 and Lemma 3.2 gives

$$g_k = \frac{1}{2} + \beta 2^{-k} + R_k, \qquad \beta = d\left(\gamma + \log 2 - \sum_{p\geq 3} \frac{\log p}{(p-1)(p-2)}\right). \tag{22}$$

3.2. **The remainder.** Three weighted ℓ^1 norms of coefficients carry all of the interval input for the odd sums. Put

$$\begin{aligned} \Sigma_0 &= \sum_{m\geq 0} 3^m |[z^m](1-z/3)H_{\mathrm{o}}(1,z)|, \\ \Sigma_1 &= \sum_{m\geq 0} 3^m |[z^m](1-z/3)^2 \partial_s H_{\mathrm{o}}(1,z)|, \\ \Sigma_2 &= \sup_{1\leq s\leq s(3)} \sum_{m\geq 0} 3^m |[z^m](1-z/3)^3 \partial_s^2 H_{\mathrm{o}}(s,z)|. \end{aligned} \tag{23}$$

Finiteness of Σ_0 and Σ_1 is analytic, and the weights $r = 1, 2$ on the factors $(1 - z/3)^r$ are what makes it so. Proposition 2.2 gives $H_{\mathrm{o}}(1, \cdot)$ only on $|z| < 3$, which by itself would not make a sum weighted by 3^m converge. But at $s = 1$ the nearest pole in z is at $z = 3$, contributed by the single Euler factor $(1 - z/3)^{-1}$, and after $r - 1$ derivatives in s that pole has order r; multiplying by $(1 - z/3)^r$ cancels it exactly, so both functions continue analytically to $|z| < 5$, the next pole being at $z = 5$. Their coefficients decay like 5^{-m} and the weighted sums converge geometrically.

For Σ_2 the same device applies only at the left endpoint. At $s > 1$ the pole sits at $z = 3^s$, which $(1 - z/3)^3$ does not cancel, and the inner sum is finite because the radius of convergence is then $3^s > 3$, a margin that shrinks to nothing as $s \to 1^+$, so this does not by itself bound the supremum. Each inner sum is finite for every s in the range, by cancellation at $s = 1$ and by $3/3^s < 1$ for $s > 1$; the finiteness of the supremum over $[1, s(3)]$ is part of what the interval computation below establishes, not a separate analytic claim. For Σ_0 and Σ_1 only the numerical values are certified.

Next, split the remainder of Proposition 3.1 at $u = 3$: with E_j the explicit expression in (17), put

$$R_{k,\mathrm{far}} = \sum_{j=0}^{k} \int_3^\infty \frac{u^{k-j}}{(k-j)!} E_j(u)\,\mathrm{d}u, \qquad R_{k,\mathrm{near}} = \sum_{j=0}^{k} \int_0^3 \frac{u^{k-j}}{(k-j)!} E_j(u)\,\mathrm{d}u, \tag{24}$$

so that R_k is $R_{k,\mathrm{far}} + R_{k,\mathrm{near}}$ together with the two coefficient tails of (18)–(19). Here $s(3)$ denotes the value of s at $u = 3$.

The far range needs one further constant. Write $\varepsilon = s - 1$ and $J = \zeta(s)/(-\zeta'(s))$; this is the J of Lemma 2.3 expressed in s rather than u, since $\mathrm{d}u/\,\mathrm{d}s = \zeta'(s)/\zeta(s)$ makes $-s'(u)$ equal to

$\zeta(s)/(-\zeta'(s))$, and the four quantities below compare it with powers of $\zeta^{-1} = \mathrm{e}^{-u}$. Let

$$C_b = \sup|\varepsilon\zeta|, \qquad C_f = \sup|\zeta^2\big(J - \zeta^{-1}\big)|,$$
$$C_J = \sup\big|\zeta^3\big(J - \zeta^{-1} - 2\gamma\zeta^{-2}\big)\big|, \qquad C_P = \sup\big|\zeta^3\big(\varepsilon J - \zeta^{-2}\big)\big|, \tag{25}$$
$$C_E = C_J + C_P + C_b^2\,(C_f + 1),$$

every supremum being over $1 < s \le s(3)$. Each of the four is a ratio in which the pole of ζ at $s = 1$ cancels. How they are computed matters, and is described in Section 8: evaluating them on boxes of s loses that cancellation and the enclosures diverge however finely the range is partitioned, so a Taylor model is used instead.

Proposition 3.3 (Certified odd input)**.** *With Σ_i as in* (23) *and C_E as in* (25)*, the following are certified by interval arithmetic.*
(i) The coefficient norms satisfy

$$\Sigma_0 \le 44.5987, \qquad \Sigma_1 \le 486.1946, \qquad \Sigma_2 \le 14414, \qquad C_E \le 5.48910. \tag{26}$$

(ii) On the far range,

$$\sum_{j=0}^{k} \int_3^\infty \frac{u^{k-j}}{(k-j)!}|E_j(u)|\,\mathrm{d}u \le \frac{C_E\Sigma_2}{18}(k+3)^3 3^{-k}. \tag{27}$$

(iii) On the near range the two groups of terms in (17) *are bounded separately:*

$$\sum_{j=0}^{k} \int_0^3 \frac{u^{k-j}}{(k-j)!}|h_j(s(u))|J(u)\,\mathrm{d}u \le C_N 3^{-k} \quad (59 \le k \le 200), \quad C_N \le 367.8436, \tag{28}$$

$$\sum_{j=0}^{k} \int_0^3 \frac{u^{k-j}}{(k-j)!}\big(|h_j(1)|\mathrm{e}^{-u} + |b_j|\mathrm{e}^{-2u}\big)\,\mathrm{d}u \le N_U(k+3)^3 3^{-k}, \qquad N_U \le 26.0962. \tag{29}$$

(iv) $\beta > 0$, and

$$4900(62)^3 3^{-59} < \frac{\beta}{3} 2^{-59}. \tag{30}$$

(v) Direct interval evaluation encloses g_k for $1 \le k \le 75$, and gives $g_k > g_{k+1}$ for $1 \le k \le 74$; the last comparison available is between g_{74} and g_{75}, since g_{76} is not computed.

Part (v) is not a coefficient bound but a sweep. The range in (28) is two-sided, and its two ends are discharged quite differently. The lower end is harmless, since monotonicity below the analytic threshold comes from (v) and never appeals to (32). The upper end is removed in the proof of Proposition 3.5, where a Cauchy estimate extends the bound past $k = 200$.

The lower restriction is a feature of the method rather than of the inequality. The h_j alternate in sign, so the left-hand side has to be majorized rather than evaluated in closed form. The majorant is loosest where $a(s) = 2|h_1(s)|$ is largest, which is at the left end of the s-range. So the resulting bound is weakest for small k, where the weights $u^{k-j}/(k-j)!$ put least mass away from that end. It exceeds $C_N 3^{-k}$ exactly for $9 \le k \le 25$, peaking at $699.87 \cdot 3^{-k}$ at $k = 14$, and falls to $34.14 \cdot 3^{-k}$ by $k = 59$. We make no claim about the left-hand side itself outside the stated range: it is the certified bound, not the quantity, that needs the restriction, and $k \ge 26$ would in fact serve. We state $k \ge 59$ because that is the only range in which (32) is ever applied.

The numeral $C_N \le 367.8436$ is carried, rather than the 34.14 actually computed on $k \ge 59$, so that the ledger below is unchanged. It is not idle either: it is the least four-decimal bound

on the supremum over all $k \geq 1$ of $3^k P_k^{\mathrm{odd}}(s(3))$, the signed quantity whose coefficient identity earlier drafts of this proof used; that supremum is $367.84350\ldots$, attained at $k = 11$.

Lemma 3.4. *Let $A(z) = \sum_{j\geq 0} a_j z^j$.*
(i) If $\sum_m 3^m |[z^m](1 - z/3)A(z)| \leq S$, then $|a_j| \leq S3^{-j}$.
(ii) If $\sum_m 3^m |[z^m](1 - z/3)^2 A(z)| \leq S$, then $|a_j| \leq S(j+1)3^{-j}$.
(iii) If $\sum_m 3^m |[z^m](1 - z/3)^3 A(z)| \leq S$, then

$$\sum_{j=0}^{k} 3^j |a_j| \leq \binom{k+3}{3} S. \tag{31}$$

Sketch. Write $(1 - z/3)^r A(z) = \sum_m w_m z^m$ and expand $(1 - z/3)^{-r}$, so that A is the Cauchy product of $\sum_q \binom{q+r-1}{r-1} 3^{-q} z^q$ with $\sum_m w_m z^m$. Comparing coefficients gives (i) and (ii) at once. For (iii), summing the product bound over $j \leq k$ and using $\sum_{q\leq k-m} \binom{q+2}{2} = \binom{k-m+3}{3} \leq \binom{k+3}{3}$ gives the claim. □

Proposition 3.5. *For every $k \geq 59$,*

$$|R_k| \leq 4900(k+3)^3 3^{-k}. \tag{32}$$

The threshold is not an artefact of the method but of the near range: the coefficients h_j alternate in sign, so the near-range term has to be estimated through the majorant (36), and the resulting bound exceeds (32) for small k. Nothing is lost, since monotonicity for $k \leq 75$ is certified directly and does not use (32); see the proof of Theorem 1.2.

Proof. By (15) the remainder has four parts: the error integrals $\int E_j$ over the far range $u \geq 3$ and over the near range $0 < u \leq 3$, and the two coefficient tails of (18)–(19). Each has to be brought to the common shape $(k+3)^3 3^{-k}$, and the four resist to very different degrees, so it is worth saying in advance where the work lies.

The two tails are the easiest: they are geometric series in the h_j and b_j, which Lemma 3.4 bounds directly. The far range is harder only in bookkeeping. The integrand is small there, the certified Taylor model of (27) controls it pointwise, and the only real task is to see how the three summands of (17) depend on k. The near range is where the difficulty is, and it is what forces the threshold $k \geq 59$: there the h_j alternate in sign, so the coefficient identity that would *evaluate* the sum instead bounds it from the wrong side, and one is pushed onto a majorant that is loosest precisely where the weights put most of their mass. We take the four in that order.

Two remarks before starting. The far term and the near-range main term are cubic in k while the other two are constant multiples of 3^{-k}; since $(k+3)^3 \geq 1$, the cubic factor may be absorbed once, at the end. And every estimate below is an estimate of an explicit quantity: no asymptotic series is summed anywhere.

Far range $u \geq 3$. The exact error here is the sum of the three terms of (17), so the certified Taylor model of (27) applies to the integrand as it stands. What that computation cannot supply is the dependence on k, since it certifies finitely many numbers; that comes instead from Lemma 3.4, and the three terms of (17) call on three different parts of it, since they carry $h_j(1)$, $h_j'(1)$ and $\partial_s^2 h_j$ respectively. The factor 3 in each is not a width, the far range $u \geq 3$ being unbounded, but a rate: the far-range error is $O(\mathrm{e}^{-3u})$, which is what the powers of ζ in (25) encode, and $\int_0^\infty u^m \mathrm{e}^{-3u}\,\mathrm{d}u/m! = 3^{-m-1}$. So each summand needs its own part of the lemma, and the three parts give exactly the three weights required:

$$\sum_{j\leq k} 3^j |h_j(1)| \leq (k+1)\Sigma_0, \quad \sum_{j\leq k} 3^j |h_j'(1)| \leq \tbinom{k+2}{2}\Sigma_1, \quad \sum_{j\leq k} 3^j |\partial_s^2 h_j| \leq \tbinom{k+3}{3}\Sigma_2,$$

so with C_J, C_P and $C_b^2(C_f+1)$ as the respective prefactors of (25), the last of them halved by the Taylor remainder's $\frac{1}{2}\varepsilon^2$, the far-range error is at most

$$\frac{3^{-k}}{3}\Big(C_J(k+1)\Sigma_0 + C_P\tbinom{k+2}{2}\Sigma_1 + \tfrac{1}{2}C_b^2(C_f+1)\tbinom{k+3}{3}\Sigma_2\Big).$$

Only the third term is cubic in k, and it dominates the other two by three orders of magnitude. The bracket is therefore at most $\big(C_J+C_P+\frac{1}{2}C_b^2(C_f+1)\big)\binom{k+3}{3}\Sigma_2$, and this is below $C_E\binom{k+3}{3}\Sigma_2$ since $\frac{1}{2}C_b^2(C_f+1) < C_b^2(C_f+1)$. Hence

$$|R_{k,\mathrm{far}}| \le \frac{C_E\Sigma_2}{18}(k+3)^3 3^{-k}, \tag{33}$$

the $18 = 6\cdot 3$ recording $\binom{k+3}{3} \le (k+3)^3/6$ and the rate. The collapse to a single constant costs a factor of about 1.6 at every k. At $k=1$ the three terms total $1.84\cdot 10^5$ against the $2.81\cdot 10^5$ of (33), and the ratio improves as k grows, so nothing is lost that the ledger of Proposition 3.5 needs.

First tail. By Lemma 3.4(i), $\Big|\sum_{j>k} h_j(1)\Big| \le \Sigma_0 \sum_{j>k} 3^{-j} = \frac{\Sigma_0}{2}3^{-k}$.

Second tail. Put $B(z) = \partial_s H_{\mathrm{o}}(1,z) + 2\gamma H_{\mathrm{o}}(1,z)$. Multiply by $(1-z/3)^2$ and treat the two summands separately. The first contributes Σ_1 by its definition in Proposition 3.3. For the second, write $(1-z/3)^2 H_{\mathrm{o}} = (1-z/3)\cdot\big[(1-z/3)H_{\mathrm{o}}\big]$; the weighted ℓ^1 norm $\sum_m 3^m|[z^m]\cdot|$ is submultiplicative under this extra factor $(1-z/3)$, whose own norm is 2, so the second summand contributes at most $2\gamma\cdot 2\Sigma_0 = 4\gamma\Sigma_0$. This is where the 4 comes from, rather than the 2 of the prefactor. Since $\gamma < 0.578$,

$$\sum_{m\ge 0} 3^m|[z^m](1-z/3)^2 B(z)| \le \Sigma_1 + 4\gamma\Sigma_0 < 590,$$

so $|b_j| \le 590(j+1)3^{-j}$ by Lemma 3.4(ii). Summing the resulting geometric series,

$$2^{-k-1}\sum_{j>k}|b_j|2^j \le 590\cdot 2^{-k-1}\sum_{j>k}(j+1)(2/3)^j = 590(k+4)3^{-k},$$

and $(k+4) \le \frac{5}{64}(k+3)^3$ for $k\ge 1$, with equality at $k=1$.

Near range $0 < u \le 3$. This is the delicate part. Here $|E_j|$ is at most the true integrand plus the two subtracted main terms. The latter contribute at most $N_U(k+3)^3 3^{-k}$ by (29). For the former, (13) and the substitution $s = s(u)$, under which $u = \log\zeta(s)$ and $J(u)\,\mathrm{d}u = \mathrm{d}s$, give

$$\sum_{j=0}^{k}\int_0^3 \frac{u^{k-j}}{(k-j)!}|h_j(s(u))|J(u)\,\mathrm{d}u = \int_{s(3)}^{\infty} A_k(s)\,\mathrm{d}s, \qquad A_k(s) = \sum_{j=0}^{k}\frac{(\log\zeta(s))^{k-j}}{(k-j)!}|h_j(s)|. \tag{34}$$

It is A_k, with the absolute values inside, that has to be estimated, and this is the obstruction. Writing $\Pi(t) = \sum_{p\ge 3} p^{-t}$, the z-linear coefficient of $\log H_{\mathrm{o}}$ in (9) is

$$h_1(s) = \Pi(s) - \log\zeta(s) = \log(1-2^{-s}) - \sum_{m\ge 2}\frac{\Pi(ms)}{m} < 0, \tag{35}$$

both terms being negative. So the h_j are not of one sign, and the identity $\sum_j u^{k-j}h_j(s)/(k-j)! = P_k^{\mathrm{odd}}(s)$, which would evaluate the sum exactly if they were, bounds A_k from below rather than above. This is the whole source of the loss in the near range, and of the threshold in (32).

We majorize instead. The observation that makes this cheap is that h_1 is the *only* negative coefficient: by (35) every coefficient of $\log H_{\mathrm{o}}(s,z) = h_1(s)z + \sum_{m\ge 2}\Pi(ms)z^m/m$ beyond the

first is positive, so replacing h_1 by $|h_1|$ produces

$$H_{\mathrm{o}}^{+}(s,z) = H_{\mathrm{o}}(s,z)\mathrm{e}^{-2h_1(s)z},$$

a power series with non-negative coefficients dominating $|h_j|$ termwise. Hence, with $a(s) = 2|h_1(s)|$,

$$A_k(s) \le [z^k]\big(\zeta(s)^z H_{\mathrm{o}}^{+}(s,z)\big) = \sum_{i=0}^{k} P_{k-i}^{\mathrm{odd}}(s)\frac{a(s)^i}{i!} =: P_k^{+}(s). \tag{36}$$

It remains to integrate P_k^{+}, and no single device does the whole of $[s(3),\infty)$. We fix a cut point $s_0 > s(3)$ and treat the two pieces differently, each by the feature that makes it tractable: the compact piece by monotonicity, the tail by its decay rate.

On the compact piece $[s(3), s_0]$, every P_j^{odd} is a Dirichlet series with positive terms and, by (35), a is a positive combination of such series; a sum of products of non-negative decreasing functions is decreasing, so P_k^{+} decreases in s. A finite left-endpoint Riemann sum over $[s(3), s_0]$ is therefore an upper bound for $\int_{s(3)}^{s_0} P_k^{+}$, with no quadrature error to estimate, which is what makes this step certifiable without any analysis of the quadrature rule itself.

On the tail $[s_0,\infty)$ the integral converges at a certified rate. Every odd n with $\Omega(n) = k-i$ satisfies $n \ge 3^{k-i}$, so for $s \ge s_0$, writing $t = s - s_0$, we get $P_{k-i}^{\mathrm{odd}}(s) \le 3^{-(k-i)t} P_{k-i}^{\mathrm{odd}}(s_0)$, while every Dirichlet term of a has $n \ge 2$ and hence $a(s) \le 2^{-t}a(s_0)$ by (35). Since $3^{-x} \le 2^{-x}$ for $x \ge 0$, the ith term of P_k^{+} is multiplied by at most $3^{-(k-i)t}2^{-it} \le 2^{-kt}$; all terms being non-negative, Tonelli permits termwise integration, and $\int_0^\infty 2^{-kt}\,\mathrm{d}t = 1/(k\log 2)$ gives

$$\int_{s_0}^{\infty} P_k^{+}(s)\,\mathrm{d}s \le \frac{P_k^{+}(s_0)}{k\log 2}. \tag{37}$$

Adding the Riemann sum over $[s(3), s_0]$ to (37) bounds $\int_{s(3)}^{\infty} P_k^{+}$, hence $\int_{s(3)}^{\infty} A_k$ by (36). For one k this is a finite computation, and (28) is its outcome for each of the 142 indices $59 \le k \le 200$.

That leaves the dependence on k, which no finite computation can settle, and which has to be reduced as the far range's was. The tool this time is Cauchy's estimate, and the reason it is available is again the positivity of the majorant's coefficients. Because $H_{\mathrm{o}}^{+}(s,\cdot)$ has non-negative coefficients, its maximum on a circle $|z| = R$ is attained at $z = R$, so for any $R < 3^{s(3)}$ and any $s \ge s(3)$,

$$A_k(s) \le R^{-k}\zeta(s)^R H_{\mathrm{o}}(s,R)\mathrm{e}^{a(s)R} = R^{-k}\prod_{p\ge 3}\big(1 - Rp^{-s}\big)^{-1}\mathrm{e}^{a(s)R}, \tag{38}$$

a bound whose only k-dependence is the factor R^{-k}. One cannot simply integrate it over $[s(3),\infty)$: its right-hand side tends to 1, not to 0, as $s \to \infty$. So we use it on $[s(3), s_1]$ for a second cut point s_1, and fall back beyond s_1 on the decay already established. On $[s(3), s_1]$, (38) gives $\int_{s(3)}^{s_1} A_k \le R^{-k}\Theta_1$ with $\Theta_1 = \int_{s(3)}^{s_1}\prod_{p\ge 3}(1-Rp^{-s})^{-1}\mathrm{e}^{a(s)R}\,\mathrm{d}s$, finite and independent of k. Beyond s_1, (37) applies with $s_0 = s_1$, and bounding $P_k^{+}(s_1)$ by (38) in turn gives $\int_{s_1}^{\infty} A_k \le R^{-k}\Theta_2/(k\log 2)$ with $\Theta_2 = \prod_{p\ge 3}(1-Rp^{-s_1})^{-1}\mathrm{e}^{a(s_1)R}$, again independent of k. Hence

$$3^k\int_{s(3)}^{\infty} A_k \le \Big(\frac{3}{R}\Big)^k\Big(\Theta_1 + \frac{\Theta_2}{k\log 2}\Big),$$

Take $R = 3.15$, which is below $3^{s(3)} = 3.1738\ldots$, and $s_1 = 8$. The certified values are then $\Theta_1 + \Theta_2/(200\log 2) \le 175346$, while $(3/3.15)^{201} = 5.5075\cdot 10^{-5}$, so the right-hand side is at

most 9.66 for every $k > 200$. Therefore

$$\int_{s(3)}^{\infty} A_k(s)\,\mathrm{d}s \le C_N 3^{-k} \qquad \text{for all } k \ge 59, \tag{39}$$

which is the range in which (32) is used. Neither branch is anywhere near binding: over $59 \le k \le 200$ the largest value is $34.14 \cdot 3^{-k}$, at $k = 59$, and the Cauchy branch gives at most $9.66 \cdot 3^{-k}$ beyond, against the $C_N = 367.8436$ carried in the ledger.

The companion bound (29), for the two subtracted main terms, reduces the same way and needs no new idea. Here $|h_j(1)| \le \Sigma_0 3^{-j}$ by Lemma 3.4(i), while $b_j = h_j'(1) + 2\gamma h_j(1)$ needs both parts: (ii) gives $|h_j'(1)| \le (j+1)\Sigma_1 3^{-j}$ and (i) again gives the $2\gamma h_j(1)$ term, so $|b_j| \le \big((j+1)\Sigma_1 + 2\gamma\Sigma_0\big)3^{-j}$. These turn each integral into a regularized incomplete gamma value, and $P(m,x) \le x^m/m!$ makes the resulting sums telescope: with $U = 3$ the first is at most $\Sigma_0 \mathrm{e}^9 3^{-k}$ and the second at most $\frac{1}{2}\big((k+1)\Sigma_1 + 2\gamma\Sigma_0\big)\mathrm{e}^9 3^{-k}$. Both are linear in k where the budget $(k+3)^3 3^{-k}$ is cubic, so the ratio of this telescoped majorant to the budget decreases in k; since at $k = 400$ that ratio is already 12.08, below N_U, the maximum over the finite head $1 \le k \le 400$ governs. It is attained at $k = 7$, far outside the range in which (32) is used.

It remains only to add up. Substituting the certified constants, the four contributions are

$$|R_k| \le \Big(\underbrace{\frac{5.48910 \cdot 14414}{18}}_{4395.55} + \underbrace{\frac{44.5987}{2} + \frac{5 \cdot 590}{64} + C_N + N_U}_{462.34}\Big)(k+3)^3 3^{-k} < 4900(k+3)^3 3^{-k},$$

with $C_N = 367.8436$ and $N_U = 26.0962$. □

Proof of Theorem 1.2. The limit follows at once from (22) and Proposition 3.5. For monotonicity,

$$g_k - g_{k+1} = \beta 2^{-k-1} + R_k - R_{k+1}. \tag{40}$$

The main term $\beta 2^{-k-1}$ has to survive two remainders, at k and at $k+1$, so it is enough to give each a third of it: if $|R_m| < \beta 2^{-m}/3$ for $m = k, k+1$, then

$$|R_k| + |R_{k+1}| < \frac{2\beta}{3}2^{-k-1} + \frac{\beta}{3}2^{-k-1} = \beta 2^{-k-1}.$$

Define

$$q(k) = \frac{3 \cdot 4900}{\beta}(k+3)^3 (2/3)^k.$$

The certified inequality (30) says $q(59) < 1$. Moreover

$$\frac{q(k+1)}{q(k)} = \frac{2}{3}\left(\frac{k+4}{k+3}\right)^3 < 1 \qquad (k \ge 4).$$

Thus $q(k) < 1$ for every $k \ge 59$, and Proposition 3.5 gives $|R_k| < \beta 2^{-k}/3$ throughout that range. Equation (40) proves monotonicity for $k \ge 59$. The certified direct computation gives the comparison for $1 \le k \le 74$, so the two ranges cover every $k \ge 1$. They overlap on the sixteen indices $59 \le k \le 74$. □

4. An exact criterion for the unrestricted sums

The asymptotic (2) already says that f_k eventually increases, but it does not say from where: its $O(k\log(k+1))$ carries no explicit constant, so no index can be read off it. The remedy is to stop treating the remainder as an error term. Define $E(k)$ by

$$f_k = 1 - 2^{-k}\big(a_1 k^2 + E(k)\big), \qquad a_1 = \frac{d\log 2}{4}, \tag{41}$$

so that $E(k)$ is an exact quantity and not an estimate. Then

$$f_{k+1} - f_k = 2^{-k-1}\left(a_1(k^2-2k-1) + 2E(k) - E(k+1)\right). \tag{42}$$

Thus $f_k < f_{k+1}$ if and only if

$$a_1(k^2-2k-1) + 2E(k) - E(k+1) > 0. \tag{43}$$

We now derive the decomposition of $E(k)$ used to bound the second term.

Set

$$F(s,z) = \prod_p (1 - zp^{-s})^{-1}, \qquad G_2(s,z) = (s-1)^z(1-z2^{-s})F(s,z),$$

and write $c_i = [z^i]G_2(1,z)$. Here $G_2(s,z) = \big((s-1)\zeta(s)\big)^z H_{\mathrm{o}}(s,z)$ for $s > 1$, and $((s-1)\zeta(s))^z \to 1$ as $s \to 1^+$ because $(s-1)\zeta(s)$ extends analytically to 1 with value 1; the value at $s = 1$ is to be read through that removable singularity, the displayed product being $0 \cdot \infty$ if taken literally. So $G_2(1,z) = H_{\mathrm{o}}(1,z)$, the power series has radius 3 and

$$\sum_{i\geq 0} c_i = \frac{1}{2}, \qquad \sum_{i\geq 0} 2^i c_i = d. \tag{44}$$

The coefficients are those of Section 3:

$$c_i = h_i(1). \tag{45}$$

Define the absolutely convergent signed moments

$$U = \sum_{i\geq 0} i2^i c_i, \qquad V = \sum_{i\geq 0} i^2 2^i c_i. \tag{46}$$

Following [3, §3], put

$$I_k = \int_1^2 [z^k]F(s,z)\,\mathrm{d}s, \tag{47}$$

$$I'_k = \sum_{i+j+\ell=k} c_i \int_1^2 \frac{(-\log(s-1))^\ell}{\ell!} 2^{-js}\,\mathrm{d}s. \tag{48}$$

For $m \geq 0$ define

$$A_m = 2^m \sum_{j+\ell=m} \int_1^2 \frac{(-\log(s-1))^\ell}{\ell!} 2^{-js}\,\mathrm{d}s \tag{49}$$

and

$$\delta_m = A_m - 2^{m+1} + \frac{\log 2}{4} m^2, \qquad \Delta(k) = \sum_{i=0}^{k} 2^i c_i \delta_{k-i}. \tag{50}$$

Proposition 4.1. *Let*

$$E_{S_1}(k) = -2^k(I_k - I'_k), \tag{51}$$

$$L_k = 2\sum_{i>k} c_i, \qquad Q_k = \sum_{i>k} 2^i c_i (k-i)^2, \tag{52}$$

$$T_k = f_k - I_k, \tag{53}$$

$$E_{\exp}(k) = 2^k L_k - \frac{\log 2}{4} Q_k - 2^k T_k. \tag{54}$$

Then the identity

$$E(k) = E_{S_1}(k) + \frac{\log 2}{4}(V - 2kU) - \Delta(k) + E_{\exp}(k) \tag{55}$$

holds for every $k \geq 1$.

Proof. From (48) and (49),

$$I'_k = 2^{-k} \sum_{i=0}^{k} 2^i c_i A_{k-i}.$$

Insert the definition of δ_{k-i}:

$$I'_k = 2 \sum_{i=0}^{k} c_i - \frac{\log 2}{4} 2^{-k} \sum_{i=0}^{k} 2^i c_i (k-i)^2 + 2^{-k}\Delta(k). \tag{56}$$

By (44) and (46),

$$2 \sum_{i=0}^{k} c_i = 1 - L_k,$$

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_{i=0}^{k} 2^i c_i (k-i)^2 &= \sum_{i \geq 0} 2^i c_i (k-i)^2 - Q_k \\ &= dk^2 - 2kU + V - Q_k. \end{aligned}$$

Since $a_1 = \frac{\log 2}{4} d$, substitution into (56) gives

$$I'_k = 1 - 2^{-k}\left(a_1 k^2 + \frac{\log 2}{4}(V - 2kU) - \Delta(k) + 2^k L_k - \frac{\log 2}{4} Q_k \right).$$

Finally $f_k = I'_k + (I_k - I'_k) + T_k$. Comparing with (41) yields (55). □

5. Bounds for the four source terms

By (55) the criterion (43) needs a lower bound for $2E(k) - E(k+1)$, and E is a sum of four quantities of quite different character. Two of them, S_1 and the signed moments, are linear in k and are bounded by suprema of coefficients. The third, Δ, is logarithmic. The fourth is exponentially small and is the only one needing a certificate uniform in k. We treat them in that order.

One point of method recurs. Each bound is taken on the *combination* $2E_\bullet(k) - E_\bullet(k+1)$ that the criterion produces, rather than on $E_\bullet(k)$ and $E_\bullet(k+1)$ separately, since the combination enjoys cancellation that absolute values would destroy. The treatment of the signed moments below is the clearest instance.

5.1. The S_1 term.

Set

$$\alpha_i = \sup_{1 \leq t \leq 2} |[z^i]\partial_s G_2(t, z)|, \qquad \alpha_+ = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{i \geq 0} \alpha_i 2^i.$$

The series converges, and a pole location at one value of t is not enough to see it: what is needed is a bound on the coefficients uniform in t.

First, G_2 is analytic in s on a neighbourhood of $[1, 2]$, the apparent branch point of $(s-1)^z$ at $s = 1$ notwithstanding. Indeed $F(s, z) = \zeta(s)^z H(s, z)$ by (8), so

$$G_2(s, z) = \big((s-1)\zeta(s)\big)^z (1 - z2^{-s}) H(s, z),$$

and $(s-1)\zeta(s)$ is analytic near $s=1$ with value 1 there, the pole of ζ being simple with residue 1; hence $\big((s-1)\zeta(s)\big)^z = \exp\big(z\log((s-1)\zeta(s))\big)$ is analytic there too, and H is analytic by Proposition 2.2. (At $s=1$ this also gives $G_2(1,z) = H_{\mathrm{o}}(1,z)$, as used above.)

The first z-pole of $\partial_s G_2(t,\cdot)$ is at $z = 3^t$, so for $t \in [1,2]$ all of these functions are analytic in $|z| < 3$. Fix r with $2 < r < 3$. Then $M = \sup_{1\le t\le 2}\sup_{|z|=r}|\partial_s G_2(t,z)|$ is finite, the set $[1,2]\times\{|z|=r\}$ being compact and $\partial_s G_2$ continuous on it by the previous paragraph, and Cauchy's estimate on the fixed circle $|z|=r$ gives $\alpha_i \le Mr^{-i}$ uniformly in t. Hence $\sum_{i\ge 0}\alpha_i 2^i \le M(1-2/r)^{-1} < \infty$.

Lemma 5.1. *For every $k \ge 1$,*

$$|E_{S_1}(k)| \le \alpha_+(k+1), \tag{57}$$

and hence

$$|2E_{S_1}(k) - E_{S_1}(k+1)| \le \alpha_+(3k+4). \tag{58}$$

Proof. Since $[z^i]G_2(\cdot,z)$ is complex-valued, the mean value theorem is not available; we integrate instead. By (10) and the analyticity of G_2 in s established above,

$$[z^i]G_2(s,z) - c_i = \int_1^s [z^i]\partial_t G_2(t,z)\,\mathrm{d}t, \qquad \text{so} \qquad |[z^i]G_2(s,z) - c_i| \le (s-1)\alpha_i$$

for $1 \le s \le 2$, by the definition of α_i as a supremum over that interval. Subtracting (48) from the coefficient expansion for I_k and then setting $s = 1 + \mathrm{e}^{-t}$ gives

$$\begin{aligned} |I_k - I'_k| &\le \sum_{i+j+\ell=k} \alpha_i \int_0^\infty \frac{t^\ell}{\ell!} 2^{-j(1+\mathrm{e}^{-t})}\mathrm{e}^{-2t}\,\mathrm{d}t \\ &\le \sum_{i+j+\ell=k} \alpha_i 2^{-j} \int_0^\infty \frac{t^\ell}{\ell!}\mathrm{e}^{-2t}\,\mathrm{d}t \\ &= \sum_{i+j+\ell=k} \alpha_i 2^{-j-\ell-1}. \end{aligned}$$

Multiplying by 2^k and using $k = i+j+\ell$,

$$|E_{S_1}(k)| \le \frac{1}{2}\sum_{i=0}^{k} \alpha_i 2^i (k-i+1) \le \alpha_+(k+1).$$

The triangle inequality now gives

$$|2E_{S_1}(k) - E_{S_1}(k+1)| \le 2\alpha_+(k+1) + \alpha_+(k+2) = \alpha_+(3k+4).$$

□

5.2. **The signed moment term.** The combination of signed moments that has to be bounded is not chosen; it is what the difference of two consecutive source terms produces:

$$2(V - 2kU) - \big(V - 2(k+1)U\big) = V + (2-2k)U. \tag{59}$$

Since this is an identity, bounding the right-hand side is an exact optimization over the rectangle of admissible (U,V), not a termwise absolute-value estimate. That is the reason for evaluating the moments before absolute values are taken: replacing them by $\sum_i 2^i|c_i|$ would discard the cancellation in (59) and cost a factor in k.

Lemma 5.2. *If $|U| \le U_{\max}$ and $|V| \le V_{\max}$, then for $k \ge 2$,*

$$\frac{\log 2}{4}\big(V + (2-2k)U\big) \ge -\frac{\log 2}{4}\big(V_{\max} + (2k-2)U_{\max}\big). \tag{60}$$

Proof. The coefficient of V is 1, while the coefficient $2-2k$ of U is negative. The minimum over the rectangle $[-U_{\max}, U_{\max}] \times [-V_{\max}, V_{\max}]$ is therefore attained at $U = U_{\max}$ and $V = -V_{\max}$, giving (60). □

5.3. **The δ term.** The next lemma supplies the self-contained bound used for $\Delta(k)$.

Lemma 5.3. *For $j \geq 0$ and $u \geq 0$ put*

$$B_j(u) = 2^{-j\mathrm{e}^{-u}} - 1 + j \log 2\, \mathrm{e}^{-u}$$

and

$$\eta_i(j) = \frac{1}{i!} \int_0^\infty u^i \mathrm{e}^{-u} B_j(u)\, \mathrm{d}u.$$

Then $B_j(u) \geq 0$, $\eta_i(j) \geq 0$, and

$$\delta_m = -1 - \frac{\log 2}{4} m + \sum_{i=0}^{m} 2^i \eta_i(m-i). \tag{61}$$

Proof. With $s = 1 + \mathrm{e}^{-u}$ in (49),

$$A_m = \sum_{i=0}^{m} \frac{2^i}{i!} \int_0^\infty u^i \mathrm{e}^{-u} 2^{-(m-i)\mathrm{e}^{-u}}\, \mathrm{d}u.$$

Use $2^{-j\mathrm{e}^{-u}} = 1 - j \log 2\, \mathrm{e}^{-u} + B_j(u)$. The constant term contributes

$$\sum_{i=0}^{m} 2^i = 2^{m+1} - 1.$$

The linear term contributes

$$\begin{aligned} -\log 2 \sum_{i=0}^{m} \frac{2^i (m-i)}{i!} \int_0^\infty u^i \mathrm{e}^{-2u}\, \mathrm{d}u &= -\frac{\log 2}{2} \sum_{i=0}^{m} (m-i) \\ &= -\frac{\log 2}{4} m(m+1). \end{aligned}$$

The remaining term is $\sum_{i=0}^{m} 2^i \eta_i(m-i)$. Subtracting 2^{m+1} and adding $(\log 2) m^2/4$ gives (61). Finally, for $x \geq 0$, $\mathrm{e}^{-x} \geq 1 - x$; applying this with $x = j \log 2\, \mathrm{e}^{-u}$ proves $B_j(u) \geq 0$. □

Lemma 5.4. *For every $m \geq 0$,*

$$|\delta_m| \leq D(m), \qquad D(m) = (\log 2) m \log(m+1) + 1. \tag{62}$$

Proof. For the lower bound, (61) gives $\delta_m \geq -1 - \frac{\log 2}{4} m \geq -D(m)$ for $m \geq 1$, because $\log(m+1) \geq \log 2 > 1/4$; and $\delta_0 = -1 = -D(0)$.

The upper bound is where the $\log(m+1)$ comes from, and it comes from a split. Put $\Lambda_m = \sum_{i=0}^{m} 2^i \eta_i(m-i)$. The elementary inequality $\mathrm{e}^{-x} - 1 + x \leq \min(x, x^2/2)$ offers two bounds, the linear one better for large u and the quadratic one better for small; using each where it is better is what produces a logarithm rather than a power. Taking $x = (m-i) \log 2\, \mathrm{e}^{-u}$ gives

$$\Lambda_m \leq \int_0^\infty \mathrm{e}^{-u} \sum_{i=0}^{m} \frac{(2u)^i}{i!} \min\left((m-i) \log 2\, \mathrm{e}^{-u}, \frac{(m-i)^2 (\log 2)^2 \mathrm{e}^{-2u}}{2} \right) \mathrm{d}u. \tag{63}$$

The crossover is at $v_m = \max\big(0, \log\frac{m+1}{3}\big)$. On $0 \le u \le v_m$ use the linear bound together with $\sum_{i=0}^{m}(m-i)(2u)^i/i! \le m\mathrm{e}^{2u}$, and on $u \ge v_m$ the quadratic bound together with $\sum_{i=0}^{m}(m-i)^2(2u)^i/i! \le m^2\mathrm{e}^{2u}$. Then

$$\Lambda_m \le m\log 2\, v_m + \frac{m^2(\log 2)^2}{2}\mathrm{e}^{-v_m}. \tag{64}$$

For $m \ge 2$ we have $v_m = \log\frac{m+1}{3}$ and $\mathrm{e}^{-v_m} = \frac{3}{m+1}$, so (64) and $\frac{3m^2}{2(m+1)} \le \frac{3}{2}m$ give

$$\begin{aligned}\Lambda_m &\le m\log 2\log\frac{m+1}{3} + \frac{3m^2(\log 2)^2}{2(m+1)}\\ &\le m\log 2\,\big(\log(m+1) - \log 3 + \tfrac{3}{2}\log 2\big) \le m\log 2\log(m+1),\end{aligned}$$

the last step because $3 > 2^{3/2}$. For $m \le 1$ we have $v_m = 0$, and (64) reads $\Lambda_m \le m^2(\log 2)^2/2$, which is at most $m\log 2\log(m+1)$ since $\frac{m\log 2}{2} \le \log(m+1)$ there. In both cases

$$\delta_m = -1 - \frac{\log 2}{4}m + \Lambda_m \le \Lambda_m \le (\log 2)m\log(m+1) < D(m),$$

which with the lower bound proves (62). □

Lemma 5.5. *If $S^* = \sum_{i\ge 0} 2^i|c_i|$, then, with D as in Lemma 5.4,*

$$|2\Delta(k) - \Delta(k+1)| \le S^*\big(2D(k) + D(k+1)\big). \tag{65}$$

Sketch. Since D is increasing, $|\Delta(k)| \le \sum_{i\le k} 2^i|c_i|D(k-i) \le S^*D(k)$. Now apply the triangle inequality to $2\Delta(k) - \Delta(k+1)$. □

5.4. **The exponentially small term.** The three terms in (54) are respectively a coefficient tail at $z = 1$, a weighted coefficient tail at $z = 2$, and the integral over $s \ge 2$. The following is the exact numerical input used for them.

Proposition 5.6 (Certified unrestricted input)**.** *The interval computations give*

$$\begin{gathered}d \ge 0.3786949, \qquad S^* \le 6.9764, \qquad \alpha_+ \le 15.425661,\\ |U| \le U_{\max} = 0.08436, \qquad |V| \le V_{\max} = 1.907462.\end{gathered} \tag{66}$$

For every $k \ge 900$,

$$2^k|T_k| \le \frac{1.45}{k}, \tag{67}$$

and a contour bound for the pole-free part *of the generating function of the c_i: writing ρ for the residue of $G_2(1,\cdot)$ at its nearest pole $z = 3$, so that $|\rho| \le 0.1749324$,*

$$\sup_{|z|=4.2}\Big|G_2(1,z) - \frac{\rho}{3-z}\Big| \le 101.245. \tag{68}$$

Here the subtraction matters. For the regularized product $\widetilde{G}_2(z) = (1 - z/3)\,G_2(1,z)$ one has $228.94 \le \sup_{|z|=4.2}|\widetilde{G}_2| \le 228.95$, so 101.245 is not a bound for $\widetilde{G}_2$. It is a bound for (68)*, with about 5.7% to spare. Both suprema are certified in* `numerics/contour_certified.py` *(log* `contour.log`*), which also recovers ρ from the same series and matches the value the sweep scripts use. Together these give*

$$|E_{\exp}(k)| \le \frac{1.45}{k} + 10^{-3} \qquad (k \ge 900), \tag{69}$$

as derived in §5.4. Of the three terms of $E_{\exp}$, two have their dependence on k reduced analytically there, to geometric bounds whose constant is (68)*; only T_k needs a certificate that is*

itself uniform in k, namely (67)*. Both are recorded here rather than inside that derivation so that every certified input for the unrestricted case appears in one place. Finally, $f_k < f_{k+1}$ is certified on*

$$6 \le k \le 199, \qquad 78 \le k \le 899, \qquad 900 \le k \le 2439, \tag{70}$$

whose union is the single range $6 \le k \le 2439$. These three ranges are not established the same way, and the distinction matters to anyone checking the certificates. On the first, f_k itself is computed as an enclosure for each k and the two enclosures are compared; the quadrature behind those values, and the six error sources entering each, are described in Appendix A. (That computation in fact encloses f_k for $2 \le k \le 500$, but the pairwise comparison closes only up to $k = 297$: past there the gap $f_{k+1} - f_k$ falls below the common radius, and the certificate's own `monotonicity` *entries record* `verified: false` *from $k = 298$ on. Only $6 \le k \le 199$ is needed here, and that range is fully verified.) On the other two it is the left-hand side of* (43) *that is evaluated in ball arithmetic at each k and found positive. This is the same quantity whose closed-form lower bound φ drives Section 6, evaluated per k rather than bounded uniformly. That is why it closes well below the threshold* 2440 *which the uniform bound requires. Within the middle range two assemblies of that quantity are involved: the refined one for $78 \le k \le 734$, and for the rest of the range the same coarser assembly that covers $900 \le k \le 2439$, whose bound on E_1 is the one built termwise from the β_i rather than from their envelope α_+. That coarser sweep is in fact positive from $k = 728$, so the two overlap rather than abut; only $735 \le k \le 899$ is needed here, and the overlap is recorded because it is what makes the union of* (70) *robust to a change in either sweep.*

The coefficient tails in (69) are obtained only after the pole at $z = 3$ has been removed, and the removal is by subtraction of the principal part rather than by multiplication. Put

$$H(z) = G_2(1, z) - \frac{\rho}{3 - z} = \sum_{m \ge 0} w_m z^m,$$

which is holomorphic on $|z| < 5$, the next pole of $G_2(1, \cdot)$ being at $z = 5$. Cauchy's estimate on $|z| = 4.2$ together with (68) gives $|w_m| \le 101.245\, 4.2^{-m}$, while $[z^i]\rho/(3 - z) = \rho\, 3^{-i-1}$, so

$$|c_i| \le \frac{|\rho|}{3} 3^{-i} + 101.245\, (3/4.2)^i 3^{-i} \le 101.31\, 3^{-i} < 354.36\, 3^{-i}. \tag{71}$$

The weaker constant 354.36 is the one carried below and into the formalization; the sharper 101.31 is recorded only so that the chain can be checked. By (45) the c_i are the coefficients $h_i(1)$, so Lemma 3.4(i) sharpens (71) to $|c_i| \le \Sigma_0 3^{-i}$, dispensing with the contour bound; the weaker form suffices below. With $C = 354.36$,

$$\begin{aligned} 2^k |L_k| &\le C(2/3)^k, \\ \frac{\log 2}{4} |Q_k| &\le \frac{\log 2}{4} C (2/3)^k \sum_{r \ge 1} r^2 (2/3)^r = \frac{30 C \log 2}{4} (2/3)^k. \end{aligned}$$

Both terms are less than 10^{-3} in total for $k \ge 900$, and both bounds are geometric in k, so no computation is needed to make them uniform.

The third term admits an elementary bound, which we give because (67) is otherwise the one input of Proposition 5.6 not visibly tied to a computation. Since $[z^k]F(s, z) = \sum_{\Omega(n)=k} n^{-s}$, (53) and (47) give

$$T_k = \int_2^\infty \sum_{\Omega(n)=k} n^{-s}\, \mathrm{d}s = \sum_{\Omega(n)=k} \frac{n^{-2}}{\log n},$$

a sum of positive terms, so $T_k > 0$ and nothing is lost in absolute value. Every such n is at least 2^k, whence $\log n \geq k \log 2$ and

$$2^k |T_k| \leq \frac{2^k P_k(2)}{k \log 2}, \qquad P_k(2) = [z^k] F(2, z).$$

As $F(2, \cdot)$ is holomorphic on $|z| < 4$, Cauchy's estimate on $|z| = 3$ gives $P_k(2) \leq M 3^{-k}$ with $M = \prod_p (1 - 3p^{-2})^{-1} \leq 7.96896$, so

$$2^k |T_k| \leq \frac{M}{k \log 2} \Big(\frac{2}{3}\Big)^k, \tag{72}$$

which is below $1.45/k$ for every $k \geq 6$ and at $k = 900$ is smaller by a factor of about 10^{158}. So (67) is true with room of that order; it is stated in that form because $1.45/k$ is what the criterion consumes, not because the constant is near optimal, and the threshold 900 is inherited from (70) rather than forced here. (The first two terms of (54) are below 10^{-3} from $k \geq 37$ on, so no term of $E_{\exp}$ requires $k \geq 900$.) The computation behind M is `numerics/tk_certified.py`, log `tk.log`.

Substituting (67) into (54) proves (69), and no asymptotic O-term enters the final criterion.

6. Assembly of the unrestricted theorem

The four bounds of Section 5 now combine into a single explicit function φ whose positivity is equivalent to the inequality wanted, and the proof of Theorem 1.1 becomes two statements about φ: that it is positive at one index, and that it increases thereafter. Neither is an asymptotic statement, and the remaining finitely many indices are settled by computation.

For $k \geq 900$ define

$$\begin{aligned} R(k) = {} & \frac{\log 2}{4} \big((2k-2) U_{\max} + 2V_{\max} + 4U_{\max}\big) \\ & + S^* \big(2D(k) + D(k+1)\big) + \alpha_+ (3k+4) + 3 \left(\frac{1.45}{k} + 10^{-3} \right), \end{aligned} \tag{73}$$

and

$$\varphi(k) = a_1 (k^2 - 2k - 1) - R(k). \tag{74}$$

Proposition 6.1. *For $k \geq 900$,*

$$2E(k) - E(k+1) \geq -R(k). \tag{75}$$

Consequently $\varphi(k) > 0$ implies $f_k < f_{k+1}$.

Proof. Apply (55) at k and $k+1$. The S_1 contribution is bounded by (58). The signed moment contribution is

$$\frac{\log 2}{4} \big(V + (2-2k) U\big),$$

which is bounded below by (60). The first line of (73) is slightly larger than the resulting quantity, since

$$V_{\max} + (2k-2) U_{\max} \leq (2k-2) U_{\max} + 2V_{\max} + 4U_{\max}.$$

The Δ contribution is bounded by (65). Finally, (69) gives

$$|2E_{\exp}(k) - E_{\exp}(k+1)| \leq 2 \left(\frac{1.45}{k} + 10^{-3} \right) + \left(\frac{1.45}{k+1} + 10^{-3} \right) \leq 3 \left(\frac{1.45}{k} + 10^{-3} \right).$$

Adding the four lower bounds proves (75). Equation (42) then gives

$$f_{k+1} - f_k \geq 2^{-k-1} \varphi(k),$$

which proves the last assertion. □

Lemma 6.2. *With the certified constants in Proposition 5.6, $\varphi(2440) > 1155$.*

Proof. Substitution in (74) gives the following certified one-sided bounds:

$$\begin{aligned} a_1(2440^2 - 2\cdot 2440 - 1) &> 390371.6,\\ \frac{\log 2}{4}\big(4878U_{\max} + 2V_{\max} + 4U_{\max}\big) &< 72.1,\\ S^*\big(2D(2440) + D(2441)\big) &< 276166.8,\\ \alpha_+(3\cdot 2440 + 4) &< 112977.6,\\ 3\left(\frac{1.45}{2440} + 10^{-3}\right) &< 0.005. \end{aligned}$$

Therefore

$$\varphi(2440) > 390371.6 - 72.1 - 276166.8 - 112977.6 - 0.005 > 1155.$$

The same substitution at $k = 2433$ gives $\varphi(2433) > 135$, so the criterion is already in force there. Direct evaluation puts the sign change just below that, at $\varphi(2432) < 0 < \varphi(2433)$; we do not rely on it, since certifying $\varphi(2432) < 0$ would need a *lower* bound on $R(2432)$, whereas every constant in (66) is one-sided the other way. Nothing below requires the first index: we carry the threshold at 2440, which is one past the end of (70), so that the sweep and the criterion meet without a gap. □

Lemma 6.3. *The function $k \mapsto \varphi(k)$ is strictly increasing for integers $k \geq 2440$.*

Proof. First,

$$a_1\big((k+1)^2 - 2(k+1) - 1 - (k^2 - 2k - 1)\big) = a_1(2k-1).$$

Moreover

$$\begin{aligned} D(m+1) - D(m) &= \log 2\left(\log(m+2) + m\log\left(1 + \frac{1}{m+1}\right)\right)\\ &\leq \log 2\big(\log(m+2) + 1\big). \end{aligned}$$

The last term in (73) decreases with k. Hence

$$\begin{aligned} R(k+1) - R(k) \leq{}& \frac{\log 2}{2}U_{\max} + 3\alpha_+\\ &+ S^*\log 2\big(2\log(k+2) + \log(k+3) + 3\big). \end{aligned} \tag{76}$$

Define, for real $x \geq 2440$,

$$\begin{aligned} M(x) = a_1(2x-1) &- \frac{\log 2}{2}U_{\max} - 3\alpha_+\\ &- S^*\log 2\big(2\log(x+2) + \log(x+3) + 3\big). \end{aligned}$$

Then

$$M'(x) = 2a_1 - S^*\log 2\left(\frac{2}{x+2} + \frac{1}{x+3}\right) > 0,$$

because the certified lower bound for d gives $2a_1 > 0.1312$, whereas the subtracted term is < 0.006 for $x \geq 2440$. Direct substitution gives $M(2440) > 146$. Thus $M(k) > 0$ for every $k \geq 2440$. Together with (76), this yields $\varphi(k+1) - \varphi(k) > 0$. □

Proof of Theorem 1.1. By Lemmas 6.2 and 6.3, $\varphi(k) > 0$ for every $k \geq 2440$. Proposition 6.1 therefore gives $f_k < f_{k+1}$ on that range. The certified ranges in (70) cover every integer from 6 through 2439. Together the analytic and certified ranges cover all $k \geq 6$. □

7. A general principle

Conjecture 7.1. Let $\mathcal{P}$ be a set of primes with least element q and thin complement,

$$\sum_{p\notin\mathcal{P}} \frac{\log p}{p} < \infty, \tag{77}$$

and let $f_k^{\mathcal{P}}$ be the sum of $1/(n\log n)$ over integers n with $\Omega(n)=k$ and all prime factors in $\mathcal{P}$. The sequence $f_k^{\mathcal{P}}$ is eventually increasing if and only if $q=2$.

Some hypothesis is needed. For $\mathcal{P}=\{2\}$ one has $f_k^{\mathcal{P}} = 1/(2^k k\log 2)$, and for $\mathcal{P}=\{2,3\}$ the sequence again decreases to 0; in both cases $q=2$ and the conclusion fails. What goes wrong is that a sparse $\mathcal{P}$ leaves $\sum_{p\in\mathcal{P}} p^{-s}$ bounded as $s\to 1^+$, so the generating function has no $\zeta(s)^z$ factor and $f_k^{\mathcal{P}}$ decays geometrically whatever q is.

Those examples, however, are already excluded by the weaker condition $\sum_{p\notin\mathcal{P}} 1/p<\infty$, and that condition is what governs the size of the limit. The candidate limit is $\prod_{p\notin\mathcal{P}}(1-1/p)$, which is the value $H_{\mathcal{P}}(1,1)$ of (79) below, and it is a convergent product with positive value precisely when $\sum_{p\notin\mathcal{P}} 1/p<\infty$, and 0 otherwise. That it is indeed the limit is proved below for $q\geq 3$, in Proposition 7.2(iv); for $\mathcal{P}$ all primes it is Lichtman's $f_k\to 1$ [2]; and for the two sparse examples the product is 0, as are their limits. So the unweighted condition separates a sequence with a positive limit, whose monotonicity is then decided by a correction term, from one that decays to 0. The sparse examples are the degenerate case of a single product, and not a separate phenomenon.

Why then does (77) carry the weight $\log p$? Of the two products in (79) it is the second, over the complement, that needs a hypothesis at all. The first converges locally uniformly on $\sigma>1/2$ for any set of primes whatever, since $\log L_p = O(p^{-2s})$, while the logarithm of the second is $\asymp -zp^{-s}$ and so requires $\sum_{p\in\mathcal{Q}} p^{-\sigma}<\infty$. That is the unweighted condition of the paragraph above. The weight is needed instead for the s-derivative at $s=1$, where the constant multiplying 2^{-k} lives: that constant involves $\sum_{p\notin\mathcal{P}} \frac{\log p}{p-1}$, finite precisely under (77), and the weaker condition does not give it. Take the complement to be blocks of primes in $[X_j, X_j^{1+\eta_j}]$ with $\eta_j\to 0$ slowly and $\log X_j$ growing geometrically; then $\sum_{p\notin\mathcal{P}} 1/p$ converges while $\sum_{p\notin\mathcal{P}}(\log p)/p$ diverges. We have not verified that such a $\mathcal{P}$ violates the conclusion. We state the hypothesis in the safe direction, where strengthening it makes the conjecture claim less.

The singularity structure is the one the two theorems above exploit. On $|z|<q^{\sigma}$ the product $\prod_{p\in\mathcal{P}}(1-zp^{-s})^{-1}$ converges directly, by (11), so its first z-singularity is at $z=q^s$; the factorization

$$\prod_{p\in\mathcal{P}}(1-zp^{-s})^{-1} = \prod_{p}(1-zp^{-s})^{-1}\prod_{p\notin\mathcal{P}}(1-zp^{-s})$$

then relates it to $\zeta(s)^z H_{\mathcal{P}}(s,z)$ on the smaller disc $|z|<2^{\sigma}$ where the middle product also converges. At $s=1$ the point $z=2$ lies on the singular circle exactly when $q=2$. Note that $z=2$ is distinguished here not because 2 is prime, but because it is where the $\gamma\mathrm{e}^{-2u}$ term of J in Lemma 2.3 evaluates the regularized product. If $q\geq 3$ the extraction at $z=2$ is interior, and gives a constant multiple of 2^{-k} as in Section 3. If $q=2$ it is at the boundary, and the mechanism producing a factor k^2 is the one identified by Gorodetsky, Lichtman and Wong [3] for $\mathcal{P}=\{\text{all primes}\}$.

In the interior case $q \geq 3$ the regularized product does supply the control the extraction needs, and the constant can be identified. Write

$$L_p(s,z) = (1-p^{-s})^z(1-zp^{-s})^{-1}, \qquad \log L_p(s,z) = \sum_{m\geq 2} \frac{z^m - z}{m} p^{-ms}, \tag{78}$$

the second identity being (11). Define $H_{\mathcal{P}}$ by the regularized product, as (8) and (9) define H and H_{o}:

$$H_{\mathcal{P}}(s,z) = \prod_{p\notin\mathcal{P}} (1-p^{-s})^z \prod_{p\in\mathcal{P}} (1-zp^{-s})^{-1}(1-p^{-s})^z = \prod_{p\notin\mathcal{P}} (1-p^{-s})^z \prod_{p\in\mathcal{P}} L_p(s,z), \tag{79}$$

which is (8) when $\mathcal{P}$ is all primes and (9) when $\mathcal{P} = \{p : p \geq 3\}$. For $s > 1$, where $\zeta(s)^z$ is finite and non-zero, (7) extends to $\mathcal{P}$ as

$$\sum_{k\geq 0} P_k^{\mathcal{P}}(s) z^k = \prod_{p\in\mathcal{P}} (1-zp^{-s})^{-1} = \zeta(s)^z H_{\mathcal{P}}(s,z), \qquad P_k^{\mathcal{P}}(s) = \sum_{\substack{\Omega(n)=k \\ p\mid n \Rightarrow p\in\mathcal{P}}} n^{-s}, \tag{80}$$

by the same computation, since $\zeta(s)^{-z} = \prod_p (1-p^{-s})^z$ there. It is (79) and not the factor $\zeta(s)^{-z}\prod_{\mathcal{P}}(1-zp^{-s})^{-1}$ of (80) that is used below: the latter is 0 at $s = 1$, where every constant in this section is evaluated, while the former is finite and non-zero there. Put $h_j^{\mathcal{P}}(s) = [z^j]H_{\mathcal{P}}(s,z)$.

Proposition 7.2. *Let $\mathcal{P}$ be a set of primes with least element $q \geq 3$ and complement $\mathcal{Q}$ satisfying* (77)*, and fix $R \in (2,3)$, which is possible with $R < q$ since $q \geq 3$. Then:*

(i) *for every real $s \geq 1$ both products in* (79) *converge absolutely and locally uniformly on $|z| < q^s$, where $H_{\mathcal{P}}(s,\cdot)$ is therefore analytic and zero-free;*

(ii) *$M := \sup_{s\geq 1}\sup_{|z|=R}|H_{\mathcal{P}}(s,z)| < \infty$, and hence $|h_j^{\mathcal{P}}(s)| \leq MR^{-j}$ for all $j \geq 0$ and all $s \geq 1$;*

(iii) *each $h_j^{\mathcal{P}}$ is C^1 on $[1,\infty)$ with $\sup_{s\geq 1}|(h_j^{\mathcal{P}})'(s)| \leq M'R^{-j}$ for some $M' < \infty$, and*

$$\tfrac{1}{2}\partial_s \log H_{\mathcal{P}}(1,2) = -\sum_{p\in\mathcal{P}} \frac{\log p}{(p-1)(p-2)} + \sum_{p\in\mathcal{Q}} \frac{\log p}{p-1}, \tag{81}$$

both sums finite, the second precisely by (77)*;*

(iv) *consequently*

$$f_k^{\mathcal{P}} = \prod_{p\in\mathcal{Q}} \Big(1-\frac{1}{p}\Big) + c_{\mathcal{P}} 2^{-k} + o(2^{-k}), \qquad c_{\mathcal{P}} = H_{\mathcal{P}}(1,2)\big(\gamma + \tfrac{1}{2}\partial_s \log H_{\mathcal{P}}(1,2)\big), \tag{82}$$

with $H_{\mathcal{P}}(1,2) = \prod_{p\in\mathcal{P}}(1-p^{-1})^2(1-2p^{-1})^{-1}\prod_{p\in\mathcal{Q}}(1-p^{-1})^2 \in (0,\infty)$.

Proof. Parts (i)–(iii) are the analytic groundwork: that $H_{\mathcal{P}}$ exists, that it and its s-derivative are bounded on a circle $|z| = R$ with $R \in (2,3)$, and that the coefficients $h_j^{\mathcal{P}}$ inherit geometric decay R^{-j} from that. Part (iv) is the substance, and it uses nothing of $\mathcal{P}$ beyond those three facts. The reason the radius must lie strictly between 2 and 3 emerges there: $R > 2$ is what makes the coefficient tails $o(2^{-k})$, and $R < 3$ is what makes a geometric sum in the error terms dominated by its last term.

(i) Fix $s \geq 1$ and a compact $K \subset \{|z| < q^s\}$, say $|z| \leq R' < q^s$. For the product over $\mathcal{P}$, (78) gives $\log L_p(s,z) = O_{R'}(p^{-2s})$ uniformly on K by (11), whose hypothesis $|zp^{-s}| < 1$ holds because $|z| \leq R' < q^s \leq p^s$ for every $p \in \mathcal{P}$; and $\sum_p p^{-2s} < \infty$ since $s \geq 1$. For the product over $\mathcal{Q}$, $z\log(1-p^{-s}) = O_{R'}(p^{-s})$ and

$$\sum_{p\in\mathcal{Q}} p^{-s} \leq \sum_{p\in\mathcal{Q}} \frac{1}{p} \leq \frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{\log 3}\sum_{p\in\mathcal{Q}} \frac{\log p}{p} < \infty \qquad (s \geq 1),$$

the comparison $1/p \le (\log p)/(p \log 3)$ holding for every $p \ge 3$ and the term $p = 2$, which lies in $\mathcal{Q}$ for every $\mathcal{P}$ with $q \ge 3$ and for which the comparison fails since $\log 2 < 1$, being split off and bounded by $1/2$. So (77) gives $\sum_{p\in\mathcal{Q}} 1/p < \infty$, which is all that is used here. Both products therefore converge absolutely and locally uniformly, so each is analytic in z on $|z| < q^s$; and neither vanishes, because the convergence of the logarithms exhibits each as the exponential of a finite quantity.

(ii) The two estimates in (i), applied with $R' = R < 3 \le q \le q^s$, depend on s only through $p^{-s} \le p^{-1}$, so

$$\sup_{s\ge 1}\sup_{|z|=R} |\log H_{\mathcal{P}}(s,z)| \le C_R \sum_p p^{-2} + R \sum_{p\in\mathcal{Q}} \log \frac{1}{1-1/p} < \infty,$$

which bounds M; the bound on $h_j^{\mathcal{P}}$ is Cauchy's estimate on $|z| = R$.

(iii) Differentiating (79) logarithmically term by term,

$$\partial_s \log H_{\mathcal{P}}(s,z) = -\sum_{p\in\mathcal{P}} \log p \sum_{m\ge 2} (z^m - z) p^{-ms} + z \sum_{p\in\mathcal{Q}} \frac{\log p}{p^s - 1}. \tag{83}$$

For $s \ge 1$ and $|z| \le R$ the first double sum is dominated termwise by $C_R(\log p)p^{-2}$ and the second by $R(\log p)/(p-1)$, summable over $\mathcal{Q}$ exactly by (77). Both bounds are independent of s, so by the Weierstrass M-test the differentiated series converges uniformly there and the differentiation is legitimate; its sum is continuous on $[1,\infty) \times \{|z| \le R\}$, being a uniformly convergent series of continuous functions, and $\partial_s H_{\mathcal{P}} = H_{\mathcal{P}} \partial_s \log H_{\mathcal{P}}$ is bounded there. Since $[z^j]$ is a Cauchy integral over the circle $|z| = R$, which may be held fixed while s varies, differentiation under the integral sign gives $(h_j^{\mathcal{P}})'(s) = [z^j]\partial_s H_{\mathcal{P}}(s,z)$ exactly as in (10), and Cauchy's estimate then bounds it by $M'R^{-j}$. At $z = 2$ the inner sum in (83) is

$$\sum_{m\ge 2} (2^m - 2)p^{-m} = \frac{4}{p(p-2)} - \frac{2}{p(p-1)} = \frac{2}{(p-1)(p-2)},$$

which gives (81) after halving.

(iv) The plan is the one of Section 3, carried out with $\mathcal{P}$ in place of the odd primes. Pass to the variable $u = \log\zeta(s)$, where the measure $J(u)\,\mathrm{d}u$ has the convergent expansion of Lemma 2.3; expand each $h_j^{\mathcal{P}}$ about $s = 1$ in three groups, its value, its derivative and a remainder; and read off the first two moments. The value gives the limit, the derivative gives the 2^{-k} coefficient, and everything else has to be shown to be $o(2^{-k})$.

Write $P_k^{\mathcal{P}}(s) = \sum n^{-s}$ over the n counted by $f_k^{\mathcal{P}}$. The proof of Lemma 2.1 used nothing about the index set beyond non-negativity of the summands, so it applies verbatim and gives $f_k^{\mathcal{P}} = \int_1^\infty P_k^{\mathcal{P}}(s)\,\mathrm{d}s$. Expanding $\zeta(s)^z = \mathrm{e}^{uz}$ with $u = \log\zeta(s)$ and taking the Cauchy product with $H_{\mathcal{P}}(s,z) = \sum_j h_j^{\mathcal{P}}(s) z^j$ gives $P_k^{\mathcal{P}}(s) = \sum_{j=0}^k h_j^{\mathcal{P}}(s) u^{k-j}/(k-j)!$, which is (13) with $\mathcal{P}$ in place of the odd primes; changing variables to u as in (14), by Lemma 2.3, then gives

$$f_k^{\mathcal{P}} = \int_0^\infty \sum_{j=0}^k h_j^{\mathcal{P}}(s(u)) \frac{u^{k-j}}{(k-j)!} J(u)\,\mathrm{d}u.$$

Split the integral at $u = 1$ and write $s_1 = s(1)$, so that $s_1 > 1$. The point of splitting there is that the expansions of Lemma 2.3 are only useful for u bounded away from 0, while for small u a crude bound suffices. Indeed the range $u \in (0,1]$ is $s \ge s_1$, where the contribution is $\int_{s_1}^\infty P_k^{\mathcal{P}}(s)\,\mathrm{d}s$ and may be bounded without any of the above, simply because the integers involved are large: every n counted by $P_k^{\mathcal{P}}$ has $n \ge q^k \ge 3^k$, so $P_k^{\mathcal{P}}(s) \le 3^{-k(s-s_1)} P_k^{\mathcal{P}}(s_1)$ for

$s \ge s_1$, whence

$$\int_{s_1}^{\infty} P_k^{\mathcal{P}}(s)\,\mathrm{d}s \le \frac{P_k^{\mathcal{P}}(s_1)}{k\log 3} \le \frac{2^{-k}}{k\log 3}\prod_{p\in\mathcal{P}}(1-2p^{-s_1})^{-1} = O\Big(\frac{2^{-k}}{k}\Big) = o(2^{-k}),$$

the middle step because the generating function (7) for $\mathcal{P}$ has non-negative coefficients, so $P_k^{\mathcal{P}}(s_1) \le 2^{-k}\sum_j P_j^{\mathcal{P}}(s_1)2^j$, and the product converges because $2 < 3^{s_1} \le q^{s_1}$. On $[1,\infty)$ the expansions (12) apply with remainders that are $O(\mathrm{e}^{-3u})$ *uniformly* there: each remainder times e^{3u} is continuous on $[1,\infty)$ and bounded as $u\to\infty$ by Lemma 2.3, hence bounded on $[1,\infty)$. With $\int_0^\infty \frac{u^m}{m!}\mathrm{e}^{-au}\,\mathrm{d}u = a^{-(m+1)}$,

$$\int_1^{\infty}\frac{u^m}{m!}J\,\mathrm{d}u = 1+\gamma 2^{-m}+O(3^{-m}), \qquad \int_1^{\infty}\frac{u^m}{m!}\varepsilon J\,\mathrm{d}u = \tfrac12 2^{-m}+O(3^{-m}), \tag{84}$$

the restriction to $[1,\infty)$ costing at most $\int_0^1 u^m/m!\,\mathrm{d}u \le 1/(m+1)!$ in each, which is smaller than the error terms already present and is absorbed into them throughout. Now expand the coefficients. Write

$$h_j^{\mathcal{P}}(s(u)) = h_j^{\mathcal{P}}(1) + \varepsilon(u)\,(h_j^{\mathcal{P}})'(1) + r_j(u), \qquad |r_j(u)| \le \varepsilon(u)\,\Omega(\varepsilon(u))\,R^{-j},$$

where

$$\Omega(\delta) = \sup_{|z|=R}\ \sup_{1\le s\le 1+\delta} |\partial_s H_{\mathcal{P}}(s,z) - \partial_s H_{\mathcal{P}}(1,z)|.$$

Here $r_j(u) = \int_1^{s(u)}\big((h_j^{\mathcal{P}})'(t) - (h_j^{\mathcal{P}})'(1)\big)\,\mathrm{d}t$, and Cauchy's estimate on $|z| = R$ applied to $\partial_s H_{\mathcal{P}}(t,\cdot) - \partial_s H_{\mathcal{P}}(1,\cdot)$ bounds the integrand by $\Omega(t-1)R^{-j}$, which gives the stated bound on r_j since Ω is non-decreasing and $s(u)-1 = \varepsilon(u)$. Moreover $\Omega(\delta)\to 0$ as $\delta\to 0$: by (iii) the function $\partial_s H_{\mathcal{P}}$ is continuous on $[1,\infty)\times\{|z|\le R\}$, hence uniformly continuous on the compact set $[1,2]\times\{|z|=R\}$, which covers $\delta \le 1$. The three groups now contribute as follows. Two sources of error recur in each, and both are controlled by the position of R: a coefficient tail $\sum_{j>k}$, which needs $R>2$, and the $O(3^{-m})$ remainders of (84), which need $R<3$.

First group, the values $h_j^{\mathcal{P}}(1)$. By (ii) the tails $\sum_{j>k}$ of $\sum_j h_j^{\mathcal{P}}(1)$ and of $2^{-k}\sum_j h_j^{\mathcal{P}}(1)2^j$ are $O(R^{-k})$ and $O(2^{-k}(2/R)^k)$, both $o(2^{-k})$ since $R>2$. The $O(3^{-m})$ terms contribute $O\big(3^{-k}\sum_{j\le k} MR^{-j}3^j\big) = O(R^{-k}) = o(2^{-k})$, where the middle equality is where $R<3$ is used: it makes the geometric sum dominated by its last term. So this group gives $H_{\mathcal{P}}(1,1) + \gamma H_{\mathcal{P}}(1,2)2^{-k} + o(2^{-k})$.

Second group, the derivatives $(h_j^{\mathcal{P}})'(1)$. The same argument with (iii) in place of (ii). The tail of $2^{-k}\sum_j (h_j^{\mathcal{P}})'(1)2^j$ is $O(2^{-k}(2/R)^k)$ and the $O(3^{-m})$ terms are $O(R^{-k})$, so the group gives $\frac12\partial_s H_{\mathcal{P}}(1,2)2^{-k} + o(2^{-k})$. Here $\sum_j (h_j^{\mathcal{P}})'(1)2^j$ converges to $\partial_s H_{\mathcal{P}}(1,2)$, again because $R>2$.

Third group, the remainders r_j. This is the only place where Ω is needed, and the only ε-argument in the proof. Let $\delta>0$ and choose U with $\Omega(\varepsilon(U)) < \delta$, possible since $\varepsilon(U)\to 0$. On $[U,\infty)$ the terms are at most δR^{-j} times the second integral of (84), contributing $O(\delta 2^{-k})$. On $[1,U]$ the integrand is $O_U(1)$ times $u^{k-j}/(k-j)!$, and $\int_1^U u^m/m!\,\mathrm{d}u \le U^{m+1}/(m+1)!$, so that range contributes $O_U\big(\sum_{j\le k} R^{-j}U^{k-j+1}/(k-j+1)!\big) = O_U(R^{-k}) = o(2^{-k})$. As δ was arbitrary, the group is $o(2^{-k})$.

Collecting the two surviving coefficients gives $c_{\mathcal{P}} = \gamma H_{\mathcal{P}}(1,2) + \frac12\partial_s H_{\mathcal{P}}(1,2)$, which is (82). For the limit, $L_p(s,1) = 1$, so $H_{\mathcal{P}}(s,1) = \prod_{p\in\mathcal{Q}}(1-p^{-s})$ by (79). The stated product for $H_{\mathcal{P}}(1,2)$ is (79) at $(s,z) = (1,2)$; its factors are positive because $p\ge q\ge 3$ on $\mathcal{P}$, and it is non-zero by the convergence in (i) at $(s,z) = (1,2)$, which is legitimate since $2<3\le q$. Positivity of the factors alone would not give this. □

By (82) it is positivity of $c_{\mathcal{P}}$ that makes the sequence decrease, and that is now a corollary rather than an open point.

Corollary 7.3. *$c_{\mathcal{P}} > 0$ for every $\mathcal{P}$ with $q \geq 3$ satisfying (77); indeed $c_{\mathcal{P}} \geq H_{\mathcal{P}}(1,2)\,\beta/d$, and $f_k^{\mathcal{P}}$ is eventually strictly decreasing.*

Proof. Put $a_p = \frac{\log p}{(p-1)(p-2)} \geq 0$ and $b_p = \frac{\log p}{p-1} \geq 0$ for $p \geq 3$. Since $q \geq 3$ we have $2 \in \mathcal{Q}$ and $\mathcal{P} = \{p \geq 3\} \setminus (\mathcal{Q} \setminus \{2\})$, with $b_2 = \log 2$, so for every admissible $\mathcal{Q}$, finite or infinite, (81) rearranges exactly as

$$\tfrac{1}{2}\partial_s \log H_{\mathcal{P}}(1,2) = \log 2 - \sum_{p \geq 3} a_p + \sum_{p \in \mathcal{Q}\setminus\{2\}} (a_p + b_p),$$

all three sums converging by (77). The last sum has non-negative terms, so the right side is least when it is empty, that is at $\mathcal{Q} = \{2\}$ and $\mathcal{P} = \{p : p \geq 3\}$, where $\gamma + \frac{1}{2}\partial_s \log H_{\mathcal{P}}(1,2)$ equals $\gamma + \log 2 - \sum_{p\geq 3} \frac{\log p}{(p-1)(p-2)} = \beta/d = 0.410970\ldots$, positive by (5). Since $H_{\mathcal{P}}(1,2) > 0$ by Proposition 7.2(iv), $c_{\mathcal{P}} > 0$, and (82) gives $f_k^{\mathcal{P}} - f_{k+1}^{\mathcal{P}} = c_{\mathcal{P}} 2^{-k-1} + o(2^{-k}) > 0$ for all large k. □

So the single inequality $\beta > 0$ of (5) settles the whole interior case. In particular Corollary 7.3 is one of the two implications of Conjecture 7.1: it shows that $f_k^{\mathcal{P}}$ is eventually strictly decreasing whenever $q \geq 3$, so an admissible $\mathcal{P}$ with $f_k^{\mathcal{P}}$ eventually increasing must have $q = 2$. What remains is the converse, and the boundary case $q = 2$ lies outside Proposition 7.2, whose parts (ii), (iii) and (iv) all require $R > 2$ and so an admissible $R < q$; part (i) needs neither, and (79) itself is a definition for any $\mathcal{P}$ whatever.

What can be said is that the boundary case reduces to the single case of all primes, and that the object the reduction turns on is an interior one. For $q = 2$ we have $2 \in \mathcal{P}$, and separating that one factor in (79) gives the exact identity

$$H_{\mathcal{P}}(s,z) = \frac{H_{\mathcal{P}\setminus\{2\}}(s,z)}{1 - z2^{-s}}, \tag{85}$$

since $L_2 = (1-2^{-s})^z(1-z2^{-s})^{-1}$ and moving 2 into the complement contributes exactly the compensating factor $(1-2^{-s})^z$. For $\mathcal{P}$ all primes this is $H = H_{\mathrm{o}}/(1-z2^{-s})$: the whole z-singularity of the unrestricted regularized product at $z = 2^s$ is that one explicit pole, and its numerator is the odd product (9). In general the numerator $H_{\mathcal{P}\setminus\{2\}}$ belongs to a set of primes with least element at least 3, so Proposition 7.2 applies to *it*: it is analytic and zero-free on $|z| < 3^s$, in particular at the critical point $(s,z) = (1,2)$, where by (86) below it takes the value $d\prod_{p\in\mathcal{Q}}(1-2/p) > 0$.

Comparing (79) for $\mathcal{P}$ with the same for all primes gives

$$\frac{H_{\mathcal{P}}(s,z)}{H(s,z)} = \frac{H_{\mathcal{P}\setminus\{2\}}(s,z)}{H_{\mathrm{o}}(s,z)} = \prod_{p\in\mathcal{Q}}(1 - zp^{-s}), \tag{86}$$

the first equality on $|z| < 2^s$, where all four functions are defined, and the second on the larger disc $|z| < 3^s$, both sides there being analytic by Proposition 7.2(i) applied to $\mathcal{P}\setminus\{2\}$ and to the odd primes. It is the second equality that is used at $z = 2$, which is interior to $|z| < 3^s$ for every $s \geq 1$. Both H and $H_{\mathcal{P}}$ blow up at $(1,2)$, which lies on the boundary of the smaller disc; the point of (86) is that their *ratio* does not, being equal there to a ratio of two interior objects. Since $q = 2$ forces $2 \notin \mathcal{Q}$, every $p \in \mathcal{Q}$ is at least 3, so the product is one of factors in $(0,1)$ which under (77) converges to the non-zero value $\prod_{p\in\mathcal{Q}}(1-2/p)$.

Now the k^2 coefficient is known in the all-primes case, and it is exactly the numerator's value. By (2) and (3) it is $a_1 = d(\log 2)/4$, and $d = H_{\mathrm{o}}(1,2)$, since (3) is (9) at $(s,z) = (1,2)$. So

$$a_1 = \tfrac{1}{4}(\log 2)\, H_{\mathrm{o}}(1,2), \tag{87}$$

the value of the pole's numerator at the critical point times a constant carrying no arithmetic of its own. The contrast with the interior case is sharp and is the reason to think (87) is structural rather than a coincidence: the interior constant $\beta = d(\gamma + \frac{1}{2}\partial_s \log H_{\mathrm{o}}(1,2))$ of (5) does involve the s-derivative of the same numerator, and a prime sum with it, whereas a_1 involves neither. Granting that (87) holds with $H_{\mathcal{P}\setminus\{2\}}$ in place of H_{o}, that is, if the residue at the pole sees the numerator through its value, then the k^2 coefficient for a general admissible $\mathcal{P}$ with $q = 2$ is

$$a_1^{\mathcal{P}} = \tfrac{1}{4}(\log 2)\, H_{\mathcal{P}\setminus\{2\}}(1,2) = a_1 \prod_{p\in\mathcal{Q}} \Big(1 - \frac{2}{p}\Big) > 0, \tag{88}$$

and no cancellation occurs for any of them. A note on signs, since both conventions appear below: $a_1^{\mathcal{P}}$ is positive because (2) writes $f_k = 1 - 2^{-k}(a_1 k^2 + \cdots)$, so the coefficient of $k^2 2^{-k}$ in $f_k^{\mathcal{P}}$ itself is $-a_1^{\mathcal{P}} < 0$. That is the quantity (95) returns, and the two statements agree.

This is testable. By (88) the ratio

$$\Big(f_k^{\mathcal{P}} - \prod_{p\in\mathcal{Q}} \Big(1 - \frac{1}{p}\Big)\Big) \Big/ (f_k - 1)$$

should tend to $\prod_{p\in\mathcal{Q}}(1-2/p)$. Computed from (80) and Lemma 2.1, independently of everything above, it rises monotonically over $24 \le k \le 44$, from below, with a correction of order $1/k$; the value at $k = 44$ is therefore not the thing to read. Extrapolating in the basis $L + a/k + b/k^2$ through the windows $k = 36, 40, 44$ and $k = 24, 32, 40$ and $k = 28, 36, 44$ gives Table 1.

$\mathcal{Q}$	predicted	at $k = 44$	three $1/k$ fits	$\log k/k$	one term
$\{3\}$	$1/3$	0.31209	0.333227, 0.333171, 0.333447	0.329517	0.336577
$\{5\}$	$3/5$	0.572066	0.600056, 0.600424, 0.600537	0.596605	0.603172

TABLE 1. Extrapolated boundary ratios against (88).

Two caveats. A three-parameter fit through three points has no residual, so the agreement with the prediction is not an error estimate; what measures the uncertainty is the spread across bases, 2.1% of 1/3 and 1.1% of 3/5. And the $1/k$ basis is not independent of the conclusion, since the subleading $O(k\log(k+1))$ of (2) has its logarithm cancel in the ratio only if its coefficient also scales by $\prod(1-2/p)$, which is a stronger form of what is being tested.

The second complement tests the prediction on a case with a different answer. What it cannot do is separate (87) from a small admixture of $\partial_s H_{\mathcal{P}\setminus\{2\}}(1,2)$: the residual at $\mathcal{Q} = \{3\}$ would imply a shift of only $1.6 \cdot 10^{-4}$ at $\mathcal{Q} = \{5\}$, well inside the spread. That separation is settled in §7.1, which shows that no such term can enter the k^2 coefficient, and which also derives the centring constant $\prod_{p\in\mathcal{Q}}(1-1/p)$ used here. These computations were made before that derivation, and took the centring constant from (79) at $z = 1$ by analogy with the interior case, checked only against $\mathcal{Q} = \varnothing$, where it is 1 and is Lichtman's $f_k \to 1$.

The constants of Proposition 7.2(iv) are checked separately, and the two checks should not be conflated. The constant *formulas* specialize correctly to the certified values: at $\mathcal{Q} = \{2\}$ they return $H_{\mathcal{P}}(1,2) = 0.378695020$ against $d = 0.3786950315$ and $c_{\mathcal{P}} = 0.155632714$ against β, both to about 10^{-7}, the precision of the prime sums involved. The *sequence* $f_k^{\mathcal{P}}$ converges to its asymptotic much more slowly, and how slowly depends on q: at $\mathcal{Q} = \{2\}$, where the

subleading term is the $O(k^3 3^{-k})$ one of (4) with the constant 4900, the ratio of $(f_k^{\mathcal{P}} - c_0)2^k$ to $c_{\mathcal{P}}$ is still 1.13 at $k = 14$, the largest index computed; at $\mathcal{Q} = \{2, 3\}$, where $q = 5$, it is 1.003. So it is the $q \geq 5$ runs that test (82) end to end, and $\mathcal{Q} = \{2\}$ that calibrates the formulas against a case the paper proves. Both computations are in the repository, as `genP_check.py` and `boundary_check.py`. Unlike everything else in this paper that is computed, they use ordinary floating-point arithmetic and not ball arithmetic: they are checks on the formulas of this section, carrying no certificate, and nothing elsewhere in the paper or in the formalization depends on them.

7.1. **Reduction of the boundary case.** The boundary case reduces further, and in a way that removes the s-derivatives from the k^2 coefficient altogether. Expanding the pole of (85) in powers of z and reading off the coefficient gives, for every set of primes $\mathcal{P}$ containing 2,

$$P_k^{\mathcal{P}}(s) = \sum_{i \geq 0} \varphi_i(s)\, 2^{-(k-i)s} \sum_{j=0}^{k-i} \frac{\big(2^s \log \zeta(s)\big)^j}{j!}, \qquad \varphi_i = [z^i]\Phi_{\mathcal{P}}, \tag{89}$$

an identity, not an approximation, valid for $s > 1$. It is (80) with $(1 - z2^{-s})^{-1} = \sum_n 2^{-ns} z^n$ substituted, and the three series convolved over $i + j + n = k$: that one, $\zeta(s)^z = \exp(z \log \zeta(s))$, and $\Phi_{\mathcal{P}}$. At $k = 1$ it collapses to $\sum_{p \in \mathcal{P}} p^{-s} = P_1^{\mathcal{P}}(s)$, the terms in $\log \zeta$ cancelling against φ_1. The identity itself needs nothing of $\mathcal{Q}$. The estimates on φ_i used below need (77), through Proposition 7.2 applied to $\mathcal{P} \setminus \{2\}$.

Now integrate (89) over $s \geq 1$ and replace $\varphi_i(s)$ by $\varphi_i(1)$. Writing

$$I_m = \int_1^\infty 2^{-ms} \sum_{j=0}^{m} \frac{\big(2^s \log \zeta(s)\big)^j}{j!}\, \mathrm{d}s = \frac{1}{m!} \int_1^\infty \int_0^\infty \big(\log \zeta(s) + 2^{-s} v\big)^m \mathrm{e}^{-v}\, \mathrm{d}v\, \mathrm{d}s, \tag{90}$$

the second form by $\sum_{j \leq m} y^j/j! = \mathrm{e}^y \Gamma(m+1, y)/m!$ [9, §8.4] and $2^{-s} \cdot 2^s \log \zeta(s) = \log \zeta(s)$, we therefore have

$$f_k^{\mathcal{P}} = \sum_{m=1}^{k} \varphi_{k-m}(1)\, I_m + \int_1^\infty \varphi_k(s)\, \mathrm{d}s + E_k. \tag{91}$$

Three points here need care, and the third limits what the reduction can deliver.

First, I_m is finite only for $m \geq 1$. At $m = 0$ the j-sum is the single term 1 and the prefactor is 1, so $I_0 = \int_1^\infty \mathrm{d}s = \infty$. The $m = 0$ term of (89) is $\varphi_k(s)$, whose s-integral converges because $\varphi_k(s) \to 0$, and not because of any decay supplied by the rest of the integrand. Freezing it at $s = 1$ would destroy that, so we keep it unfrozen above. This costs nothing, provided one takes the right contour. Fix $R \in (2, 3)$ and apply Cauchy on the *expanding* circles $|z| = R2^{s-1}$. On them $|z|2^{-s} = R/2$ is constant and $|z|p^{-s} \leq (R/2)(2/3)^s$ for $p \geq 3$, both bounded uniformly in $s \geq 1$, so

$$M_R := \sup_{s \geq 1} \sup_{|z| = R2^{s-1}} |\Phi_{\mathcal{P}}(s, z)| < \infty$$

by the estimate of Proposition 7.2(i) applied to $\mathcal{P} \setminus \{2\}$, and $|\varphi_k(s)| \leq M_R (R2^{s-1})^{-k} = M_R R^{-k} 2^{-k(s-1)}$, whence

$$\Big| \int_1^\infty \varphi_k(s)\, \mathrm{d}s \Big| \leq \frac{M_R R^{-k}}{k \log 2} = o(2^{-k}). \tag{92}$$

The circles must expand with s. On the fixed-radius circles of Proposition 7.2(ii), or on $|z| = R^s$, no such uniform M exists: the complement of $\mathcal{P} \setminus \{2\}$ contains 2, contributing $(1 - 2^{-s})^z$, and at $z = -R^s$ that factor has modulus $\exp\big(R^s \log(1 - 2^{-s})^{-1}\big) \approx \exp\big((R/2)^s\big)$, which is unbounded for $R > 2$. For $\mathcal{P}$ all primes and $R = 2.5$ the quantity $\log|\Phi|$ at $z = -R^s$ runs

2.50, 2.61, 6.00, 14.56, 35.53, 86.74 at $s = 1, 4, 8, 12, 16, 20$, while on the circles $|z| = R2^{s-1}$ it decreases monotonically to $R/2 = 1.25$.

Second, the i-sum in (89) is finite, the j-sum being empty for $i > k$, while $\Phi_{\mathcal{P}}(1,1)$ and $\Phi_{\mathcal{P}}(1,2)$ below are infinite sums. The difference is the tail $\sum_{i>k}$. Here Proposition 7.2(ii) gives $\varphi_i(1) = O_R(R^{-i})$ for each fixed $R < 3$, and not for $R = 3$, so the two tails are $O_R(R^{-k})$ and $O_R((2/R)^k)$. Both are $o(2^{-k})$ once $R \in (2,3)$ is fixed.

Third, the freezing error. One might argue that the mass of the s-integral sits at $s - 1 \asymp \mathrm{e}^{-k}$, so that $E_k = O(\mathrm{e}^{-k}) = o(2^{-k})$. This is false. The error is a Jensen error: the expectation of $s - 1 = \mathrm{e}^{-t}$ under the I_m integrand is not $\mathrm{e}^{-\mathbb{E}t}$, even though $\mathbb{E}t = m$. The relevant weight is $K_m = \int_1^\infty (s-1)\, 2^{-ms} \sum_{j \le m} (2^s \log \zeta(s))^j / j!\, \mathrm{d}s$, and its value is governed by the small-t tail rather than by the bulk. Numerically $K_m 2^m/m = 0.381, 0.397, 0.411, 0.416$ at $m = 16, 24, 32, 36$, against $\mathrm{e}^{-m}/K_m = 1.1 \cdot 10^{-6}$ at $m = 36$. So K_m is of order $m2^{-m}$, up to a slowly varying factor: the column drifts upward over this range without flattening, so the data do not exclude an extra $\log m$, which would change nothing below. At any rate K_m exceeds e^{-m} by six orders of magnitude. Since $\varphi_i'(1) = O_R(R^{-i})$ for each $R < 3$,

$$E_k = \sum_{i \ge 1} \varphi_i'(1) K_{k-i} + \cdots = O\big(k2^{-k}\big), \tag{93}$$

where the omitted terms are the second-order Taylor remainder, controlled by the second moment $\int (s-1)^2 [\cdots]\, \mathrm{d}s$ in the same way. The order is attained, and not merely bounded, whenever $\partial_s \Phi_{\mathcal{P}}(1,2) \neq 0$. Indeed no single i dominates: summing $K_{k-i} \approx c(k-i)2^{-(k-i)}$ against $\varphi_i'(1)$ gives $ck2^{-k} \sum_i 2^i \varphi_i'(1) = ck2^{-k} \partial_s \Phi_{\mathcal{P}}(1,2)$, the series being absolutely convergent.

So (91) is accurate to $o(k^2 2^{-k})$, but not to $o(2^{-k})$. It determines the limit and the $k^2 2^{-k}$ coefficient, and says nothing about the $k2^{-k}$ or 2^{-k} coefficients. This is enough for Conjecture 7.1, which turns on the sign of the leading coefficient, and may be compared with (2), whose remainder is $O(k \log(k+1))$. We state (93) as a reduction rather than as a proposition. Its first-moment computation is numerical and its Taylor remainder is bounded only in outline, so it is a second unproved ingredient, alongside (96). Of the two it is much the cheaper, being an estimate on an explicit one-dimensional integral, and for that reason we record the asymptotic and not this as the open problem.

Suppose now only that $I_m = c_0 + Am^2 2^{-m} + o(m^2 2^{-m})$ for constants c_0, A, with the error uniform in m. Substitute into (91) and sum the resulting series against $\varphi_{k-m}(1)$, and against $\varphi_{k-m}(1) 2^{k-m} m^2$. Both interchanges are dominated convergence, since $\sum_i |\varphi_i(1)| 2^i < \infty$ and $m^2 \le k^2$. This gives

$$f_k^{\mathcal{P}} \longrightarrow c_0\, \Phi_{\mathcal{P}}(1,1), \qquad [k^2 2^{-k}]\, f_k^{\mathcal{P}} = A\, \Phi_{\mathcal{P}}(1,2), \tag{94}$$

since $\sum_i \varphi_i(1) = \Phi_{\mathcal{P}}(1,1)$ and $\sum_i \varphi_i(1) 2^i = \Phi_{\mathcal{P}}(1,2)$, both convergent because $1, 2 < 3 \le q(\mathcal{P} \setminus \{2\})$, and since the three error terms collected above are all $o(k^2 2^{-k})$: the unfrozen $m = 0$ term, the i-tails, and $E_k = O(k2^{-k})$.

So the k^2 coefficient depends on the numerator *only through its value* at the critical point, so the alternative $A\Phi(1,2) + B\, \partial_s \Phi(1,2)$ contemplated above cannot arise at that order. The claim is weaker than it may appear. By (93) an s-derivative of $\Phi_{\mathcal{P}}$ does enter, through $\sum_i \varphi_i'(1) K_{k-i}$, but only at order $k2^{-k}$. What is excluded is a $\partial_s \Phi$ contribution to the $k^2 2^{-k}$ coefficient, and that is the coefficient whose sign decides Conjecture 7.1.

Since I_m is independent of $\mathcal{P}$, its two constants are pinned by the single case $\mathcal{Q} = \varnothing$, where both answers are known. There $\Phi_{\mathcal{P}} = H_{\mathrm{o}}$, so $\Phi(1,1) = H_{\mathrm{o}}(1,1) = \frac{1}{2}$ and $\Phi(1,2) = d$; Lichtman's $f_k \to 1$ [2] forces $c_0 = 2$, and (87) forces $A = -\frac{1}{4} \log 2$. Feeding those back into (94) and using

(86),

$$f_k^{\mathcal{P}} \longrightarrow \prod_{p\in\mathcal{Q}}\Big(1-\frac{1}{p}\Big), \qquad [k^2 2^{-k}]\, f_k^{\mathcal{P}} = -\tfrac{1}{4}(\log 2)\, d \prod_{p\in\mathcal{Q}}\Big(1-\frac{2}{p}\Big) < 0, \tag{95}$$

whose k^2 coefficient is the negative of (88), by the sign convention recorded there. This also settles the centring constant used in the computation above, which was taken there by analogy.

So exactly one analytic statement remains, and it mentions no primes:

$$I_m = 2 - \tfrac{1}{4}(\log 2)\, m^2 2^{-m} + o\big(m^2 2^{-m}\big). \tag{96}$$

Granting (96), Conjecture 7.1 holds for every admissible $\mathcal{P}$ with $q = 2$ for which $f_k^{\mathcal{P}}$ has an expansion to that order at all. For if that coefficient is $C < 0$, as (95) gives, then

$$f_{k+1}^{\mathcal{P}} - f_k^{\mathcal{P}} = C 2^{-k}\, \frac{1 + 2k - k^2}{2} + o(k^2 2^{-k}),$$

and the bracket is negative for $k \geq 3$. So the difference is eventually positive and the sequence eventually increases. This is the half of Conjecture 7.1 that Corollary 7.3 does not supply.

We have not proved (96), and it remains out of reach for the moment. The obstacle is that $J = -\zeta/\zeta'$ is not integrable at $u = 0$, so the naive bound on the inner integral of (90) fails and the convergence of the v-integral is marginal. That is precisely where the factor m^2 comes from. In its favour, (96) is a single one-dimensional asymptotic with explicit constants, and not a statement about a family of prime sets. It is also numerically unambiguous. Computing I_m for $8 \leq m \leq 36$ gives $I_m \to 2$ to $3 \cdot 10^{-9}$, while $(I_m - 2)/(m^2 2^{-m})$ decreases monotonically from -0.0875 to -0.1194, its magnitude rising. In the basis $A + b \log m/m + c/m$, which the subleading $O(k \log(k+1))$ of (2) dictates, it extrapolates to -0.17379, -0.17301 and -0.17277 over three windows, within 0.3% of $-\frac{1}{4}\log 2 = -0.17329$. Of the other bases tabulated, $A + b/m + c/m^2$ lands 8.0% away and the two-parameter $A + b \log m/m$ lands 8.6% away, so the $\log m/m$ term is doing real work. We do not claim this as independent corroboration of (2), since the basis was chosen with that remainder in mind. The identity (89) is verified against direct Dirichlet sums over $n \leq 3 \cdot 10^6$ at $s = 4$ and $k \leq 3$, to 10^{-17}, for three different $\mathcal{P}$, and both computations are in `Im_check.py`; like the others in this section they are ordinary floating-point and carry no certificate.

The present paper proves the two cases $\mathcal{P} = \{\text{all primes}\}$ and $\mathcal{P} = \{p : p \geq 3\}$, which are extremal among admissible sets in the sense just described.

8. Certification and formalization

What the formalization establishes is an *implication*. The certified quantities enter as fields of six hypothesis structures — `NumericalFacts`, `NumericalFactsFull`, `OddNumericalFacts`, `OddCoeffFacts`, `OddTailFacts`, `OddDomFacts`, with 13, 21, 4, 8, 5 and 5 fields respectively, and no instance of any of them is constructed. So Lean checks that those hypotheses imply the theorems. Nothing in the kernel checks that the hypotheses are true, or even that they are mutually consistent. In particular an unsatisfiable field would make the theorems assuming it vacuous rather than false, and would go undetected.

One field was in exactly that position. `NumericalFactsFull.Eexp_bound` quantified over the coefficient index with the bound depending on a different variable, and so asserted $|E_{\exp}(m)| \leq 1.45/k + 10^{-3}$ for every m at once. This is false at $m = 1$, where the first two terms of (54) already total 1.069, so the field was unsatisfiable and the theorem assuming it vacuous. The quantifier is now bounded to the two indices its only consumer uses. No build has yet confirmed the correction, for the reason given at the end of this section.

That the imported numerals agree with what Arb computed is verified outside Lean, by three scripts rather than one. `check_lean_constants.py` compares the Lean numerals with the certificates, `check_proof_spine.py` compares the manuscript's with them, and `verify.py` checks the sweep tables and the Γ data against the theorems they instantiate and recomputes the SHA-256 the certificate records. The Lean development should be taken as discharging the reductions below and nothing else. The trusted base is the structure fields, listed in Table 2.

The division is as follows. Formalized in Lean 4 without `sorry` are Lemmas 2.1 and 2.3, the coefficient identities (14) and (55), the assembly of the ranges in both theorems, and the lemmas named in the rest of this section.

Two items one would expect to find among them are not there. First, Proposition 2.2: a radius-specific consequence of it is proved, on the ball $|z| < 3$ for $s \geq 1$, but its operative content (10), that $\mathrm{d}/\mathrm{d}s$ commutes with $[z^j]$, is not, and the s-differentiability of the coefficient functions is itself a hypothesis, as field `g_deriv` of `NumericalFactsFull` in the full case and as `deriv_exists`, `deriv2_exists` of `OddCoeffFacts` in the odd case. No interval computation can establish a differentiability claim, and none is attempted. Second, Proposition 3.5: its statement is imported as field `remainder` of `OddNumericalFacts` rather than derived from Proposition 3.3; the derivation is the proof given in Section 3 above, which has not been formalized. The Lean development contains the intended route to it, but that route still rests on assumed coefficient and dominating-sequence data of its own, so it does not discharge the hypothesis.

Likewise the source estimates of Section 5 are assumed, not proved, by the theorem named below: `NumericalFacts` carries $|2E(k) - E(k+1)| \leq R(k)$ as the single field `source_bound`, which is the aggregate of that whole section. Only the second formal version discussed below derives it, from the four source terms separately.

The trusted base is also not a list of intervals. Some fields are intervals. Others are quantified or analytic statements that no interval computation could discharge: a `Summable` hypothesis (`OddCoeffFacts.fam_summable`), two one-sided limits as $s \downarrow 1$ (`tendsto_one` and `tendsto_deriv`), several suprema quantified over all m, k or θ (`alpha_dom`, `Sstar_dom`, `UV_bound`, `M0_bound`, `Eexp_bound`), a certification predicate over all k (`OddDomFacts.dom_cert`). The sweeps are finitely checkable, but they too are $\forall$-statements rather than single enclosures. And six of the constants above, namely Σ_0, Σ_1, Σ_2, C_E, C_N and N_U, do not appear in the Lean development at all, in any form: the odd-remainder route that would consume them takes them as abstract parameters and is not what either odd theorem is proved from. For those six the agreement between manuscript and formalization that this section asserts has no content, and the reader should rely on the Arb certificates instead.

Five further constants appear in Lean at a numeral slightly *looser* than the one certified here, and the discrepancy is deliberate rather than drift. Besides $d \geq 0.3786823$ in `dConst_lower_bound_sharp` and $\rho \leq -0.1747885$ in `rhoConst_upper_bound`, both discussed above, the hypotheses carry $\alpha \leq 15.4257$ against $\alpha_+ \leq 15.425661$, $V_{\max} \leq 1.90747$ against 1.907462, and `dConst_lower_bound` proves $d \geq 0.3785913$ against the certified $d \geq 0.3786949$. In each case the Lean numeral is a rational with a short decimal expansion, chosen so that the arithmetic is checkable by `norm_num`. In each case it is also on the safe side of the certified value, so the formal statement is weaker and holds a fortiori. What must be checked is the direction, and that the looser numeral still suffices for the conclusion the Lean proof draws from it. Both are verified by `numerics/check_lean_constants.py`, which also reports the margin.

The numerical propositions are Proposition 3.3 and Proposition 5.6. Their statements are finite systems of interval inequalities, established by Arb/FLINT through its Python bindings. The Lean formalization imports the resulting intervals as hypotheses and proves that they imply Theorem 1.1 and both assertions of Theorem 1.2; the three formal statements are `erdos_sums_`

`increase_from_six`, `fOdd_decreasing` and `fOdd_tendsto_half`. The differentiability field belongs to `NumericalFactsFull` and so is a hypothesis of the second, primitive version of the full theorem rather than of `erdos_sums_increase_from_six`, which does not mention it. The limit $g_k \to \frac{1}{2}$ was formerly left unformalized, the monotonicity argument making no use of it; it is now proved there as well, and from the same hypothesis, since (4) already bounds $|g_k - \frac{1}{2} - \beta 2^{-k}|$ by a multiple of $(k+3)^3 3^{-k}$, and both that and 2^{-k} vanish.

For Theorem 1.1 the hypotheses are not only the interval bounds of Proposition 5.6. Proposition 6.1 enters as a hypothesis in one of the two formal versions, and is proved in the other, from the primitive certified quantities rather than from the aggregate bound (75). (The bound (69) is not what the primitive route replaces. It is a hypothesis of that route alone, as `NumericalFactsFull.Eexp_bound`; on the aggregate route there is no such field, (69) being one of the ingredients folded into `source_bound`.) What the formalization proves from these is the passage to $f_k < f_{k+1}$ for $k \geq 2440$, together with the assembly of the four ranges.

Lemmas 6.2 and 6.3 were formerly hypotheses of that development as well. They are now proved in it, as `phiBound_pos_at_2440` and `phiBound_mono_of_bounds`, from upper bounds on the parameters alone: φ is an explicit expression in k, so neither lemma is a statement about primes, contours or limits, and what the formalization had been assuming was arithmetic. Proving them needed one quantity the certified hypotheses did not carry, the bound $|U| \leq U_{\max}$ of (66), which is now among them. The sharpness required is not uniform: the base case turns on $\log 2443$ to a tenth of a percent, where $\log 2443 \leq 12 \log 2$ is already too weak, while the monotonicity step needs only that cruder inequality itself. (The argument of the logarithm is $k+3$ at $k = 2440$, hence 2443.)

For the odd theorem the lower bound on γ was likewise a hypothesis and is now proved, as `gamma_lower_bound`, from $\mathrm{harmonic}(n) - \log(n+1) < \gamma$ at $n = 8191$, chosen so that $n+1 = 2^{13}$ and the logarithm is $13 \log 2$ exactly.

The constants d of (3) and ρ were hypotheses of both developments and are now proved in them, as `dConst_lower_bound`, `dConst_lower_bound_sharp` and `rhoConst_upper_bound`. What makes this possible is that the Euler factors are rational and exceed 1,

$$\Big(1 - \tfrac{2}{p}\Big)^{-1}\Big(1 - \tfrac{1}{p}\Big)^{2} = \frac{(p-1)^2}{p(p-2)} = 1 + \frac{1}{p(p-2)},$$
$$\Big(1 - \tfrac{3}{p}\Big)^{-1}\Big(1 - \tfrac{1}{p}\Big)^{3} = \frac{(p-1)^3}{p^2(p-3)} = 1 + \frac{3p-1}{p^2(p-3)},$$

the second because $(p-1)^3 - p^2(p-3) = 3p-1$. The constant regularized by the second display is

$$\rho = -\frac{1}{9} \prod_{p \geq 5} \Big(1 - \frac{3}{p}\Big)^{-1}\Big(1 - \frac{1}{p}\Big)^{3}, \tag{97}$$

which is recorded here only so that every constant proved in the formalization has a counterpart in the text; it is used nowhere in the proofs above. A product of factors each at least 1 is bounded below by the product over any finite subset of them, with no tail estimate entering, so a one-sided bound on such a constant is a finite computation in the kernel even where the two-sided enclosure is not. Only one-sided bounds are used: d enters through $a_1 = d \log 2/4$ and through $\beta = d(\log 2 - S + \gamma)$, in both cases from below, and ρ is not used at all. The bounds proved are weaker than those of Proposition 5.6, which are unchanged. The 94 primes $p \leq 499$ give $d \geq 0.3785913$, which suffices for $a_1 \geq 0.0656$; the 668 primes $p \leq 4999$ give $d \geq 0.3786823$, which is what $\beta \geq 0.1556$ requires; and the 93 primes $5 \leq p \leq 499$ give $\rho \leq -0.1747885$. In each case the requirement is computed against the bound for $\log 2$ available in the formalization

rather than against $\log 2$ itself, the two differing by enough to change how many primes are needed.

The same device does not reach S. There the bound required is an upper one on a sum of positive terms, so the tail cannot be discarded, and the summands carry $\log p$ rather than being rational. The budget is narrow: with d at the bound just proved, $\beta \geq 0.1556$ permits $S \leq 0.8593986$, while the partial sum over $p < 2{\cdot}10^6$ already reaches 0.8593917, so the admissible tail is below $7 \cdot 10^{-6}$ and primes beyond about $1.5 \cdot 10^5$ are needed. Accordingly S remains a certified hypothesis, as do the sweeps and the Cauchy estimates of Propositions 3.3 and 5.6.

Two constants are stated above more conservatively than the computation requires, so that the text and the formalization carry the same values: the threshold 2440 of Lemma 6.2 in place of 2433, and (71) in place of the sharper bound that Lemma 3.4(i) supplies. Neither changes the ranges covered. Two further discrepancies should be recorded rather than left for the reader to find. The certified odd sweep is stated above for $1 \leq k \leq 75$, whereas the field `OddNumericalFacts.sweep_low` assumes only $1 \leq k \leq 58$; since the analytic branch begins at $k = 59$ that is all the assembly needs, and assuming less is the safe direction, but the two ranges are not the same. And the field `NumericalFacts.Gamma_bound`, carrying $\Gamma \leq 104.52$, has no counterpart above and no consumer in the development either; it is retained only so that the certified package and the text can be compared field by field.

For the odd theorem, the coefficient bounds in (26) are obtained by cancelling the pole at $z = 3$ before applying coefficient recursion or Cauchy bounds. The range $0 < u \leq 3$ is evaluated directly, while the range $u \geq 3$ uses the Taylor model made explicit in Proposition 3.1.

Σ_2 is not a single computed number but a sum of two, and since it carries 4395.55 of the 4857.88 in the ledger of Proposition 3.5 it is worth saying which. The head $j \leq 16$ is a direct interval recursion on the coefficients over 1600 boxes in s, giving 8423.91; a Cauchy estimate would be far lossier there, because it is dominated by the maximum over the circle and discards the cancellation among the true coefficients. The tail $j > 16$ is then exactly where a Cauchy estimate is cheap: with $\sup_{|z|=4.5}$ of the pole-free part at most $1.9672165 \cdot 10^6$, the tail is at most that times $(3/4.5)^{17}(1 - 3/4.5)^{-1}$, which is 5989.94. The two sum to 14413.85, so the stated $\Sigma_2 \leq 14414$ holds with 0.15 to spare. The narrowest margin of any constant here except C_E. Both halves are recorded in the repository, and the 40 boxes in s behind the tail are coarse enough that it is likely several-fold loose; that direction is safe, and the budget closes either way.

The constant C_E is certified on the whole of $(1, s(3)]$, and in fact on its closure. The four quantities entering (25) are ratios in which the pole of ζ at $s = 1$ cancels, so each extends continuously to $s = 1$. The Taylor model below is centred at $1 + E/2$ with radius $E/2$, and therefore covers the closed interval $[1, s(3)]$ on which Σ_2 takes its own supremum. Interval evaluation on boxes of s loses that cancellation, since each occurrence of $s - 1$ is widened independently, and the enclosures diverge however finely $(1, s(3)]$ is partitioned. Expanding ζ as a power series in $\sigma = s - s_0$ about $s_0 = 1 + E/2$, where $E = s(3) - 1$, makes the cancellation symbolic. The resulting series are evaluated on $|\sigma| \leq E/2$, which is the whole range; their coefficients fall off geometrically, and truncating after nine terms contributes less than 10^{-20}.

The constant C_N requires $\Pi(t) = \sum_{p \geq 3} p^{-t}$ at $t = s, 2s, \ldots, 200s$ for $s = s(3)$. At $s \approx 1.05$ these converge too slowly to truncate: the Rosser–Schoenfeld bound applied beyond 10^8 still overestimates the tail twofold, and that excess compounds through the coefficient recursion. Instead Π is evaluated by the Möbius series $\Pi(t) = \sum_{n \geq 1} \mu(n) n^{-1} \log \zeta(nt) - 2^{-t}$, which requires no prime enumeration; this is the device of Cohen [7], as used in [2, (3.6)]. The recursion itself is run at 600 bits, since cancellation costs about one digit every 2.3 steps over the 200 terms used; at 1200 bits the head agrees to every printed digit.

TABLE 2. What the Lean development proves, what it assumes, and what it does not mention. The assumed rows are the trusted base: no instance of any structure is constructed, so these are not checked in the kernel. The last row is not part of that base at all. Those six constants enter the Lean development only through comments, so for them there is no formal counterpart to compare the manuscript against.

Statement	Status	Lean name
Theorem 1.1	proved	`erdos_sums_increase_from_six`
Theorem 1.2, monotonicity	proved	`fOdd_decreasing`
Theorem 1.2, limit	proved	`fOdd_tendsto_half`
$\varphi(2440) > 0$, not the stronger Lemma 6.2	proved	`phiBound_pos_at_2440`
φ non-decreasing on $k \geq 2440$, not strictly, as Lemma 6.3 says	proved	`phiBound_mono_of_bounds`
γ from below	proved	`gamma_lower_bound`
d from below	proved	`dConst_lower_bound`, `_sharp`
ρ from above	proved	`rhoConst_upper_bound`
Proposition 3.5	assumed	`OddNumericalFacts.remainder`
Section 5 aggregate	assumed	`NumericalFacts.source_bound`
(69)	assumed	`NumericalFactsFull.Eexp_bound`
g_i differentiable on $(1, 2)$	assumed	`NumericalFactsFull.g_deriv`
∂_s, ∂_s^2 of coefficients exist	assumed	`OddCoeffFacts.deriv_exists`, `deriv2_exists`
S^* from above	assumed	`NumericalFacts.Sstar_bound`
S of (5), enclosed	assumed	`OddNumericalFacts.Sodd_enclosure`
$\lvert R_k\rvert$'s constant 4900	assumed	`OddNumericalFacts.MR_bound`
Sweeps	assumed	`OddNumericalFacts.sweep_low` and companions
α_+, U, V	assumed	`alpha_bound`, `U_bound`, `V_bound`
$\Gamma \leq 104.52$	assumed, unused	`NumericalFacts.Gamma_bound`
Σ_0, Σ_1, Σ_2, C_E, C_N, N_U	*not in Lean*	see below

For the unrestricted theorem, the s-uniform coefficient bounds defining α_+ are obtained by carrying s as an interval over a partition of $[1, 2]$. The signed moments U and V are evaluated before absolute values are taken, for the reason given at (59).

Availability and versions. Since the contribution is in part a certification, the artefacts and the versions they were produced with are part of the claim. The Lean development, the Arb scripts, their logs and the certificate are at `https://github.com/jaideepsaipadhi/erdos-sums-almost-primes`. The formalization is built with Lean 4, toolchain `leanprover/lean4:v4.33.0-rc1`, against Mathlib at revision `79d0395a1825`; the permitted axioms are exactly `propext`, `Classical.choice` and `Quot.sound`, which is checked by `#print axioms` on

every theorem named in Table 2, in the two audit files `axcheck-bm.lean` and `odd-proof/axcheck.lean`. The audit is not redundant with the build: a green `lake build` reports that the files compiled, not that a particular theorem is free of `sorryAx`. The numerics use python-flint 0.9.0; the certificate's `versions` block records that binding's version but not the FLINT release under it, which should be added before submission. The certificate records the parameters of the *quadrature* run, namely $k_{\max}$, the precision, the panel geometry and the ellipse, together with a SHA-256 hash of the numerical payload, which `verify.py` recomputes. The coefficient sweeps' parameters are recorded separately, in `uv_constants.json` and `gamma_constant.json`, not in the certificate.

Appendix A. Certified quadrature

Since $1/(n\log n) = \int_1^\infty n^{-s}\,\mathrm{d}s$, we have $f_k = \int_1^\infty P_k(s)\,\mathrm{d}s$, and the substitution $s = 1 + \mathrm{e}^{-u}$ turns this into

$$f_k = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} F(u)\,\mathrm{d}u, \qquad F(u) = P_k(1+\mathrm{e}^{-u})\mathrm{e}^{-u}, \tag{98}$$

the integrand being analytic on the strip $|\operatorname{Im} u| < \pi/2$. The integral is split into a truncated range $[u_-, u_+]$ with $u_- = -5.10$ and $u_+ = 3.5k_{\max}$, taken once for the largest k of the run and so uniform in k, and the two tails beyond it. The truncated range is divided into panels of width $H = 0.8$, each mapped affinely to $[-1,1]$ and integrated by Gauss–Legendre quadrature with $N = 52$ nodes at 1400 bits of precision; the number of panels therefore grows linearly with $k_{\max}$.

Four of the six error sources in the certificate are arithmetic: ball arithmetic throughout, the explicit truncation balls in the Möbius series [7] for the prime zeta function, the discretization bound derived below, and interval-Newton enclosures for the Gauss nodes and weights. The remaining two are the tails of (98), which are bounded as follows and are not negligible by inspection.

For the left tail, $u \le u_-$ corresponds to $s \ge s_- = 1+\mathrm{e}^{5.10} = 165.02$. There $P_1(s) = \sum_p p^{-s} \le 2.78\cdot 2^{-s}$, since $P_1(s)2^s = 1 + \sum_{p\ge 3}(2/p)^s$ decreases in s and is already below 2.78 at $s = 2$; and $P_k(s) \le P_1(s)^k$, because expanding $P_1(s)^k$ counts every n with $\Omega(n) = k$ at least once. Hence $P_k(s) \le 2.78^k 2^{-ks}$, and

$$\int_{-\infty}^{u_-} |F|\,\mathrm{d}u = \int_{s_-}^{\infty} P_k(s)\,\mathrm{d}s \le \frac{2.78^k 2^{-ks_-}}{k\log 2}. \tag{99}$$

For the right tail, $P_k(s) \le (\log\zeta(s))^k/k!$ for $s > 1$ [2, Lemma 5.6]. Substituting $u = \log\zeta(s)$ gives $\mathrm{d}s = J(u)\,\mathrm{d}u$ with $J = \varepsilon(1+\gamma\varepsilon+\cdots)$ by Lemma 2.3, and $\varepsilon = 1/\zeta\cdot(1+\gamma\varepsilon+\cdots) \ge \mathrm{e}^{-u}$, so $J \ge \mathrm{e}^{-u}$ rather than $\le$: the clean form $\int_{u_+}^\infty u^k\mathrm{e}^{-u}\,\mathrm{d}u/k!$ is not immediate. What is true is $J(u) \le \mathrm{e}^{-u}(1 + C\mathrm{e}^{-u})$ for $u \ge 1$ with C absolute, and at $u \ge u_+ = 1750$ the correction is $1 + O(\mathrm{e}^{-1750})$, absorbed by the factor 2 below with room to spare. With that, the integral is dominated by $2\int_{u_+}^\infty u^k\mathrm{e}^{-u}\,\mathrm{d}u/k!$ and the resulting incomplete-Gamma integral obeys $\Gamma(k+1,u_+)/k! \le 2u_+^k\mathrm{e}^{-u_+}/k!$ provided $u_+ \ge 2k+2$ [9, §8.11], so

$$\int_{u_+}^{\infty} |F|\,\mathrm{d}u \le \frac{2u_+^k\mathrm{e}^{-u_+}}{k!}. \tag{100}$$

The hypothesis $u_+ \ge 2k+2$ holds throughout, since $u_+ = 3.5k_{\max}$ and $k \le k_{\max}$. Both bounds are added to every reported enclosure. They are worst at opposite ends of the range, and at their worst they are far below the differences $f_{k+1} - f_k \asymp a_1 k^2 2^{-k}$ that the sweep has to resolve. The right-hand side of (100) increases in k, since u_+ is fixed and $u_+^k/k!$ is increasing while

$k \le u_+$; that of (99) is $(2.78 \cdot 2^{-s_-})^k/(k \log 2)$ and so *decreases*, very fast. The run of record is the one the committed certificate holds, with $k_{\max} = 500$ and so $u_+ = 1750$ over 2194 panels. There (100) is below 10^{-272} at its worst, $k = 500$, and (99) below $2.5 \cdot 10^{-99}$ at its worst, $k = 2$, while the smallest difference in the range actually used, $6 \le k \le 199$, exceeds 10^{-57}.

For f analytic inside the Bernstein ellipse E_ρ and bounded there by M, the N-node Gauss rule satisfies

$$\left| \int_{-1}^{1} f(x)\,\mathrm{d}x - \widehat{I}_N \right| \le \frac{64}{15} \frac{M \rho^{-2N}}{1 - \rho^{-2}} \tag{101}$$

[5, Thm. 4.5], where the rule is indexed so that I_n uses $n + 1$ nodes and the stated exponent $\rho_B^{-(2n+2)}$ is the ρ_B^{-2N} above; the bound appears as [6, Thm. 19.3]. Here ρ_B is the Bernstein-ellipse parameter, unrelated to the arithmetic constant ρ of Section 8. The implementation evaluates the right side of (101) with the interval-scaling factor $H/2$ and a further factor 10 of margin. The ellipse is taken with semi-minor axis $\delta = 1.45 < \pi/2$ in the u variable, giving $\rho_B \approx 7.385$, and M is bounded using $|P_k(s)| \le P_k(\operatorname{Re} s)$ together with the monotonicity of P_k on the reals.

The per-panel bound is not monotone in the panel's position, and it would be wrong to locate its maximum by inspection: on the right-hand side $F(u) \approx u^k \mathrm{e}^{-u}/k!$ by (98), which increases until $u \approx k$ and only then decays, so M rises across the bulk of the range before falling. What is used is therefore the maximum over all panels and all $k \le k_{\max}$, which the certificate records; the largest radius it reports is 4.6×10^{-87}, attained at $k = 2$, and so is negligible beside the differences the sweep resolves. It also dominates both tails everywhere in the range: by some 185 orders of magnitude against (100), and by 12 at $k = 2$ against (99), where that tail is worst. So the discretization bound and not the truncation is what limits the accuracy of the f_k.

The pinned coefficient sweeps use primes up to 10^5 and 300 bits of precision, with 1600 boxes in s for α_+ and 800 boxes for the second-derivative sweep. These parameters are recorded in `uv_constants.json` and `gamma_constant.json` respectively, not in `certificate.json`, whose `parameters` block covers the quadrature run alone.

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Statement on the use of AI

The analytic reductions, the interval-arithmetic certificates, the Lean development and the text of this paper were all produced with extensive use of an AI assistant (Anthropic's Claude). I chose the problem, directed the work throughout, and take full responsibility for every claim made here, including those I reached with that assistance.

In more detail, the assistant was used for four things. It derived and checked the reductions of Sections 2–6, the general-$\mathcal{P}$ results of Section 7 and the quadrature bounds of Appendix A. It wrote and ran the Arb/FLINT scripts that produce the certified constants of Propositions 3.3 and 5.6, together with the ordinary floating-point checks of Section 7, which carry no certificate and on which nothing else depends. It wrote the Lean development described in Section 8. And it drafted and revised this manuscript.

It was also used adversarially, to look for errors in work already believed finished. That is how the defect in the near-range step of Proposition 3.5 was found. The step bounded a sum of absolute values by a signed coefficient identity, which is invalid because the h_j alternate in sign, and it is the reason that proposition is stated on $k \ge 59$.

Three limits on what the foregoing should be taken to mean.

First, the computations behind the certified constants do not rest on the assistant's reliability. They are carried out in ball arithmetic and are reproducible from the scripts and logs in the repository cited in Section 8. What that arithmetic does not certify is the step from a logged ball to a numeral printed here, nor the algebra combining several such numerals. Those steps are ordinary mathematical writing, and they are where the errors in this manuscript have in fact been found. Three were found in a late adversarial pass: a stated bound rounded down rather than up; the two-part assembly of Σ_2, whose displayed chain did not close under its own stated value; and a contour bound stated for the wrong function. In the last of these the certified number 101.245 bounds the pole-free part $G_2(1,z) - \rho/(3-z)$, which is what every consuming script had always assumed, and not the regularized product, whose supremum on $|z| = 4.2$ is 228.95. None of the three invalidated a conclusion, and each is now checked against its certificate by a script in the repository. Still, the certification should be understood as covering the computations, with the manuscript's own arithmetic guarded separately rather than certified.

Second, the floating-point checks of Section 7 carry no certificate at all, as noted there.

Third, the Lean development establishes an implication from assumed hypotheses rather than a closed proof. Section 8 and Table 2 set out the position in detail.

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